A Comparative Study of Job Satisfaction Between English Medium and National Curriculum School Teachers in Bangladesh

Ismat Ara Tabassum

Department of Education
Master's Thesis 30ECTS
Education
Master's Programme in Education with International and Comparative Specialisation, 120 ECTS
Spring term 2026
Supervisor: Shu-Nu Chang Rundgren

Stockholm University

A Comparative Study of Job Satisfaction Between English Medium and National Curriculum School Teachers in Bangladesh

Ismat Ara Tabassum

Abstract

Bangladesh's education system encompasses multiple parallel schooling streams, yet comparative research on how teachers experience their work across these institutional contexts remains remarkably thin. This study focuses on two of the most structurally distinct school systems, English Medium and National Curriculum, and examines whether teachers working within them experience job satisfaction differently. A cross-sectional design surveyed 300 teachers from both school types in Bangladesh, using a quantitative strategy. Data came from an adapted Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire, analysed through independent samples t-tests and multiple regression. Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory, Dinham and Scott's Three-Domain Model, and Self-Determination Theory guided the study.

The findings showed that English Medium teachers reported significantly higher overall job satisfaction than National Curriculum teachers ($M = 3.77$ vs $M = 3.25$, $p < .001$), with a moderate effect size ($d = 0.62$). English Medium teachers scored higher on all individual workplace dimensions, with the largest gaps in pay and benefits ($M = 3.12$ vs $M = 2.63$) and leadership support ($M = 3.58$ vs $M = 3.14$), and the smallest in workload and stress ($M = 3.22$ vs $M = 3.07$) — notable given that 40% of teachers earned less than 25,000 Bangladeshi Taka (BDT) per month. Four factors independently predicted satisfaction across the combined sample: pay and benefits, intrinsic satisfaction from the work itself, leadership support, and collegial relationships — together explaining 62.5% of the variance. Overall job satisfaction, in turn, was the strongest predictor of turnover intention.

The study makes an original contribution as the first comparative quantitative examination of teacher job satisfaction across Bangladesh's parallel school systems. The findings point to salary reform, leadership development, and the protection of intrinsic teaching rewards as the most urgent levers for improving teacher wellbeing and reducing attrition, particularly within the National Curriculum sector, where conditions are lower on average and more unequal across schools.

Keywords

teacher job satisfaction, English Medium schools, National Curriculum schools, Bangladesh, turnover intentions, multiple regression

Acknowledgements

Completing this thesis has been one of the hardest and most meaningful things I have done, and I did not do it alone. My deepest gratitude goes to my supervisor, Professor Shu-Nu Chang Rundgren. Her guidance was patient, her feedback was honest, and her belief in this work — even when mine wavered — made an enormous difference. I feel genuinely lucky to have had her in my corner throughout this process. I am also grateful to the professors and lecturers whose teaching sparked something in me that I carried all the way through to this thesis. Good teachers change the way you think, and several of them did exactly that for me.

To my family — you held me up through all of it, often without me even having to ask. My husband, Ashik deserves more thanks than I can put into words here. His support was steady and quiet and selfless, and this thesis would not exist without the space he made for it. My elder brother Masum was there every time I needed him — for the big things and the small ones — and I am so grateful for that. And to my little one, Tazrian, four years old and entirely unaware of what a thesis even is — you were the best reason to keep going. Every hard day was worth it because of you.

To my friends who checked in, cheered me on, and simply showed up — thank you. And a particular thank you to Auna, who went out of her way to help with data collection. Her kindness and friendship meant more than she probably knows.

This thesis is for all of you.

Table of Contents

Abstract i

Acknowledgements ii

Table of Contents iii

List of Tables vi

List of Figures vii

List of Abbreviations viii

Chapter 1: Introduction 1

1.1 Background 1
1.2 Rationale of the Study 2
1.3 The Context of Schooling in Bangladesh 3
1.4 The Relevance to ICE 3
1.5 Aim and Research Questions 5
1.6 Organisation of the Thesis 5

Chapter 2: Literature Review 6

2.1 Conceptualising Teacher Job Satisfaction 6
2.2 Factors Influencing Teacher Job Satisfaction 7
2.2.1 Leadership Support 7
2.2.2 Workload and Stress 8
2.2.3 Pay and Benefits 9
2.2.4 Working Conditions and Resources 9
2.2.5 Collegial Relationships and Autonomy 10
2.2.6 Student Behaviour and Intrinsic Satisfaction 10
2.2.7 Job Satisfaction and Intention to Stay or Leave 11
2.3 Teacher Job Satisfaction in Bangladesh: Existing Evidence and Research Gaps 12
2.4 Summary 13

Chapter 3: Theoretical and Analytical Framework 15

3.1 Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory 15
3.2 Dinham and Scott's Three-Domain Model of Teacher Satisfaction ... 16
3.3 Self-Determination Theory 17
3.4 Conceptual and Analytical Framework of the Present Study 18
3.5 Summary 19

Chapter 4: Methodology 20

4.1 Research Paradigm 20
4.2 Research Design 20
4.2.1 Justification for the Quantitative Strategy 21
4.3 Population and Sampling 21
4.3.1 Population 21
4.3.2 Sampling Technique 21
4.3.3 Sample Size 21
4.4 Research Instrument 22
4.5 Data Collection Procedure 22
4.6 Validity and Reliability 23
4.6.1 Validity 23
4.6.2 Reliability Testing — Pilot Study 24
4.6.3 Reliability Testing — Main Study 24
4.6.4 Data Screening and Preparation 25
4.6.5 The Instrument — Reverse Coding and Composite Scores 26
4.7 Ethical Considerations 26
4.8 Use of Artificial Intelligence Tools 27
4.9 Summary 27

Chapter 5: Findings 28

5.1 Demographic Characteristics of Respondents 28
5.2 Descriptive Statistics of Study Variables 30
5.3 Overall Job Satisfaction Between English Medium and National Curriculum School Teachers 32
5.4 Factors Related to Teacher Job Satisfaction 34
5.5 Teachers' Job Satisfaction and Intention to Stay or Leave 37

5.6 Summary of Findings 40

Chapter 6: Discussion 42

6.1 Discussion of Research Question 1 42
6.2 Factors Related to Teacher Job Satisfaction (Research Question 2) . 43
6.2.1 Pay and Benefits as the Strongest Predictor..... 43
6.2.2 Intrinsic Satisfaction from Work Itself 44
6.2.3 Leadership Support 45
6.2.4 Collegial Relationships 46
6.2.5 Non-Significant Predictors..... 46
6.3 Discussion of Research Question 3: Job Satisfaction and Intention to Stay or Leave..... 47
6.4 Implications of the Findings 49
6.5 Limitations of the Study 51
6.6 Suggestions for Future Research..... 52
6.7 Summary..... 53

Chapter 7: Conclusion 54

7.1 Overview of the Study..... 54
7.2 Summary of Main Findings..... 54
7.3 Contribution of the Study 55
7.4 Implications for Policy and Practice..... 56
7.5 Final Reflections..... 57

References **59**

Appendix **63**

Appendix A: Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (Adapted TJSQ) 63

List of Tables

Table 4.1 Reliability Statistics 23
Table 5.1 Demographic characteristics of respondents 27
Table 5.2 Descriptive statistics of variables 30
Table 5.3 Group statistics for job satisfaction 31
Table 5.3b Independent samples t-test results for overall job satisfaction 31
Table 5.4 Multiple regression analysis: Predictors of overall job satisfaction..... 33
Table 5.4b Mean scores by school type across all workplace factors 35
Table 5.5 Multiple regression analysis: Predictors of intention to leave 37
Table 5.6 Summary of research questions, methods, and key findings 39

List of Figures

Figure 1 Conceptual Framework of the Study 18
Figure 2 Distribution of respondents by salary range 29
Figure 3 Mean job satisfaction by school type 32
Figure 4 Significant predictors of job satisfaction 36
Figure 5 Relationship between job satisfaction and intention to leave 38
Figure 6 Significant predictors of intention to leave (standardised beta coefficients) 39

List of Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Full form
AI	Artificial Intelligence
BDT	Bangladeshi Taka
BMRC	Bangladesh Medical Research Council
EM	English Medium
GDPR	General Data Protection Regulation
IBM	International Business Machines
ICE	International and Comparative Education
IL	Intention to Leave
MPO	Monthly Payment Order
NC	National Curriculum
NCTB	National Curriculum and Textbook Board
OECD	Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
RQ	Research Question
SDT	Self-Determination Theory
SPSS	Statistical Package for the Social Sciences
TALIS	Teaching and Learning International Survey
TIMSS	Trends in International Mathematics and Science Study
TJSQ	Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire
UNESCO	United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization

Chapter 1: Introduction

1.1 Background

Bangladesh's education system is one of the most rapidly expanding in South Asia, yet it faces a persistent challenge in retaining qualified and motivated teachers across its parallel schooling systems (Mousumi & Kusakabe, 2021, pp. 449). Teacher job satisfaction is recognised internationally as a key determinant of professional commitment, instructional quality, and retention. And yet, when it comes to comparing satisfaction across English-medium and National Curriculum schools — two very different environments, the research is surprisingly thin.

Teachers who experience higher levels of job satisfaction tend to demonstrate stronger professional commitment and sustained engagement with their work, while dissatisfaction has been linked to emotional exhaustion, reduced performance, and increased turnover intentions (Skaalvik & Skaalvik 2011, p. 1030). This matters because few factors shape the quality of education more directly than the people delivering it. Teachers do far more than deliver content — they shape how students learn, how they engage with others, and how they begin to understand themselves as learners. The conditions under which this work happens therefore matter a great deal, not just for the teachers themselves, but for the broader health and sustainability of the education system. A system that neglects what sustains its teachers is, in effect, undermining itself. Central to this is the question of job satisfaction. At its most fundamental, teacher job satisfaction describes the affective relationship a teacher has with their work — the degree to which their professional experience generates positive or negative feelings across its various dimensions (Dinham & Scott, 1998, p. 363). What shapes those feelings is not one thing but many — leadership, pay, working conditions, autonomy, collegial relationships, workload and the weight each carries shifts depending on the institutional context (Skaalvik & Skaalvik, 2011, p. 1030). That context is where this study begins.

In Bangladesh, the education landscape is made up of several distinct schooling streams. Among these, National Curriculum schools and English-medium schools stand out as perhaps the most institutionally distant from one another. The two systems diverge across a range of dimensions: how teachers are hired and paid, how schools are governed, and what professional life actually looks like on a day-to-day basis. The structural and institutional differences between these two school systems mean teachers are unlikely to experience their roles in the same way — responsibilities, expectations, and access to support all shift depending on where they work. Bangladeshi teachers, more broadly, are navigating a profession under visible strain. Workloads have grown, accountability demands have sharpened, and available resources rarely match what the job requires. These are not background conditions. They press directly on whether teachers find meaning in their work and whether they intend to stay. Examining job satisfaction within this specific context, therefore, is not a peripheral concern. It sits close to the centre of any honest conversation about educational quality in Bangladesh.

Existing studies have focused almost exclusively on teachers within the National Curriculum system, particularly government-run primary school contexts (Ahamed et al., 2013; Akter & Alam, 2023; Tasnim, 2006; Sultana et al., 2017). English-medium schoolteachers remain entirely absent from the empirical literature, despite the rapid expansion of English-medium education as a market-driven alternative to the national curriculum system (Mousumi & Kusakabe, 2017, pp. 679, 683). No comparative study has yet examined whether teachers working across these two parallel systems

experience their professional lives in similar or meaningfully different ways — a gap that is difficult to overlook given how distinct the systems are in structure, language, and institutional culture. This absence in the literature points to something worth addressing, not just academically but practically. Research that cuts across both systems has the potential to surface insights that single-system studies simply cannot offer, and those insights carry real implications for how policy is shaped and how practice is supported on the ground in Bangladesh. This study takes a step towards addressing that gap.

1.2 Rationale of the Study

The absence of comparative evidence across Bangladesh's parallel school systems is not merely an academic oversight — it has real consequences for how policy is designed. Salary reforms calibrated to the Monthly Payment Order (MPO)-supported structures of National Curriculum schools may be ill-suited to English Medium institutions operating on market-driven pay arrangements. Leadership development programmes designed for hierarchically managed National Curriculum (NC) schools may not address the different professional dynamics of commercially oriented English Medium (EM) contexts. Without comparative evidence, policymakers are working with an incomplete picture of the workforce they are trying to support.

The existing Bangladesh-focused literature, while valuable in establishing baseline evidence within the National Curriculum context, carries three specific limitations. First, it has concentrated almost exclusively on public primary school teachers (Ahamed et al., 2013; Sultana et al., 2017; Akter & Alam, 2023; Tasnim, 2006), leaving both English Medium teachers and National Curriculum secondary school teachers substantially underrepresented. Second, no study has used a common measurement framework to compare predictors of satisfaction across both systems simultaneously — meaning that even where individual factors have been studied, cross-system comparison has been impossible. Third, the relationship between job satisfaction and teachers' intention to remain in or leave the profession remains largely unexamined within the specific dual-system context of urban Bangladesh, despite the direct relevance of this relationship to teacher retention and educational sustainability.

These gaps matter not only because they limit academic understanding but because they limit the precision of any policy response. English-medium schools are no longer a peripheral feature of Bangladesh's educational landscape. They are a growing and structurally distinct sector employing a significant portion of the country's qualified urban teaching workforce. Understanding how teachers in this sector experience their work, and how that compares to their National Curriculum counterparts, is a prerequisite for any serious approach to improving teacher wellbeing, reducing attrition, and sustaining educational quality across both systems.

The present study responds to these gaps through a comparative quantitative strategy, using a common measurement instrument across both school types to examine satisfaction levels and their predictors for the first time. By extending the analysis to include teachers' intention to stay or leave, it also contributes evidence to the domain of teacher retention, where the practical stakes are highest and the existing Bangladeshi evidence is thinnest.

1.3 The Context of Schooling in Bangladesh

Bangladesh runs several parallel school systems that sit side by side but rarely meet. They follow different curricula, answer to different authorities, and serve families from different social and economic backgrounds. Students seldom move between them, and the bodies that run them are under no obligation to coordinate (Mousumi & Kusakabe, 2021, p. 449). This study is concerned with two of these systems: National Curriculum schools and English-medium schools.

National Curriculum schools account for the great majority of schooling in the country. They teach the syllabus set by the National Curriculum and Textbook Board (NCTB) and enter their students for the national public examinations (Mousumi & Kusakabe, 2021, p. 452). Most teach in Bangla, though the system also includes "English version" schools, which follow the same national curriculum but deliver it in English (Mousumi & Kusakabe, 2017, p. 681). What holds the stream together is the shared NCTB curriculum and national assessment, rather than any single language of instruction. The sector is large by any measure. The Annual Primary School Census counted close to 134,000 primary schools, and at the secondary level around 92.5 per cent of schools are privately managed, most of them government-aided institutions where teachers draw the larger part of their pay from the state through the Monthly Payment Order scheme (Mousumi & Kusakabe, 2021, pp. 451–452). Bangla itself holds a particular place in national life, bound up with the 1952 Language Movement and the country's emergence as an independent nation in 1971 (Imam, 2005, p. 472), and it remains the language of instruction in most National Curriculum schools, even as the English-version strand within the same system grows.

English-medium schools work on a different footing altogether. English holds no official status in Bangladesh, but in practice it is the language of higher education, of the better-paid professions, and of the courts. As the economy opened up and a wealthier middle class grew, more parents came to see English as the surest route to a secure future for their children, and demand for English-medium schooling rose with it (Mousumi & Kusakabe, 2017, pp. 681–683; 2021, p. 452). These schools are almost all private and fee-paying. They teach foreign curricula, mainly the British Cambridge and Pearson Edexcel systems, and cluster in the cities, Dhaka above all (Mousumi & Kusakabe, 2017, p. 683). Because the state's language policy was never meant to apply to private providers, the sector grew quickly and with little oversight, and even the basic question of how many such schools exist has no firm answer: the first official survey was not attempted until 2010, and it failed to reach every school (Mousumi & Kusakabe, 2021, pp. 453–454). The defining line between the two systems is therefore curricular rather than simply linguistic: National Curriculum schools, whether teaching in Bangla or in English, follow the national NCTB framework, while English-medium schools follow foreign curricula and foreign examinations — and those structural differences carry directly into the conditions their teachers face.

1.4 The Relevance to ICE

This study speaks directly to the field of International and Comparative Education, not because it crosses national borders, but because it engages with something comparative education has long been concerned with — how institutional structures, curricular arrangements, and organisational conditions shape the experiences of those working within them (Bray, Adamson, & Mason, 2014, pp. 7–10). Bangladesh, with its two parallel and institutionally distinct school systems, offers a compelling site for exactly this kind of inquiry. Placing English-medium and National Curriculum schools side by side

allows for a closer look at how differing contexts bear on teacher wellbeing and professional experience — a question that sits comfortably within the comparative tradition while remaining grounded in a single national setting.

Teacher job satisfaction is not a peripheral concern — it sits at the heart of questions that comparative and international education scholars have long grappled with: how to sustain educational quality, how to address equity, and how to build systems that do not burn through the people who run them. A substantial body of international research has established that teacher wellbeing and motivation are among the strongest determinants of teaching quality and student outcomes, particularly in low- and middle-income countries where systems are asked to deliver a great deal with relatively little (UNESCO, 2015; OECD, 2020). Viewed through a comparative lens, job satisfaction becomes something richer than a measure of how a teacher feels on a given day. It becomes a window into how systemic conditions are actually lived. Governance structures, accountability mechanisms, employment arrangements — these do not remain at the level of policy. They work their way into classrooms, into routines, into the texture of a working day, shaping what the job asks of people and what, if anything, it gives back.

Bangladesh makes this study particularly relevant to the field of comparative and international education. It is a context that concentrates many of the pressures that define schooling across the Global South — rapid system expansion, deepening private-sector involvement, and rising social expectations of what education should deliver (Lewin, 2007, pp. 2- 3). These forces do not simply reshape schools in the abstract; they restructure the conditions in which teachers actually work. English-medium schooling in Bangladesh is itself a product of these pressures. Its growth reflects the influence of globalisation and marketisation on educational provision, driven in large part by parental demand for an internationally oriented education. But it also reflects something less neutral — a pattern of stratification in which market forces carve out parallel educational tracks serving different socioeconomic groups, and in doing so, produce meaningfully different working environments for the teachers within them (Mousumi & Kusakabe, 2017, pp. 679, 683). It is a particularly clear instance of dynamics playing out across low- and middle-income countries more broadly. Comparing teacher job satisfaction across English-medium and National Curriculum schools therefore offers insights into how global and local forces intersect within national education systems, a key concern of ICE scholarship.

What this study ultimately offers is empirical ground for a conversation that has largely been theoretical — how institutional differences within a single country can produce genuinely unequal professional experiences for teachers. That kind of evidence matters for comparative education because it shifts the focus inward, showing that cross-system variation does not require crossing borders to be significant. The findings have practical reach too, feeding into broader discussions around teacher policy, school governance, and whether current arrangements are sustainable for the workforce over time. More than that, they push toward something comparative education has consistently called for — research that is sensitive to context rather than imported from elsewhere and applied wholesale. In that sense, the study is not just an addition to the literature but a contribution to how the field thinks about teacher wellbeing in diverse and often underexamined settings.

1.5 Aim and Research Questions

The aim of this study is to compare job satisfaction between English Medium and National Curriculum school teachers in Bangladesh, and to identify the factors that relate to teacher job satisfaction and teachers' intention to remain in the profession.
The specific research questions are:

1. Is there any difference in overall job satisfaction between English Medium and National Curriculum school teachers in Bangladesh?
2. Is there any difference in the factors related to teacher job satisfaction between English Medium and National Curriculum school teachers in Bangladesh?
3. Is there any difference in teacher job satisfaction related to teachers' intention to stay or leave their current school or profession between English Medium and National Curriculum school teachers in Bangladesh?

1.6 Organisation of the Thesis

Following this introductory chapter, the thesis is organised into six further chapters. Chapter 2 reviews existing empirical research on teacher job satisfaction, examining key factors influencing satisfaction and its relationship with teachers' intention to remain in the profession, before identifying the research gaps that justify the present study. Chapter 3 presents the theoretical and analytical frameworks guiding the study, drawing on Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory, Dinham and Scott's Three-Domain Model, and Self-Determination Theory, and introduces the conceptual framework used to examine the relationships between workplace factors, job satisfaction, and intention to remain in the profession.

Chapter 4 describes the research design, sampling strategy, data collection procedures, and statistical methods used in the study, and discusses issues of validity, reliability, and ethical considerations. Chapter 5 presents the statistical findings, including descriptive statistics, independent-samples t-tests, and multiple regression results addressing the three research questions. Chapter 6 interprets the findings in relation to the research questions, existing literature, and the theoretical frameworks, and discusses implications, limitations, and directions for future research. Chapter 7 summarises the main findings and contributions of the study and offers final reflections on its significance for teacher policy and practice in Bangladesh.

Chapter 2: Literature Review

This chapter reviews existing empirical research on teacher job satisfaction to situate the present study within the broader academic literature. The review is organised thematically, beginning with conceptual clarification before examining the factors most consistently associated with satisfaction across international and low- and middle-income country contexts. Rather than simply summarising what individual studies have found, the review identifies tensions and limitations within the existing evidence base that motivate the comparative approach adopted in this study. The chapter concludes by reviewing the existing Bangladeshi evidence and identifying the specific gaps that the present study addresses.

2.1 Conceptualising Teacher Job Satisfaction

Teacher job satisfaction is a widely studied but variably defined construct in educational research. At its core, the concept captures the degree to which individuals respond positively both emotionally and cognitively to their work and the conditions surrounding it (Spector, 1997, as cited in Pepe et al., 2017, p. 396). In the specific context of teaching, Dinham and Scott (1998) offer a more textured account which describes satisfaction as something shaped by the push and pull between intrinsic factors embedded in the nature of the work itself and extrinsic factors that sit at its edges - administrative conditions, institutional arrangements, and the like (p. 363). What makes this framing useful is what it implies: satisfaction is not a fixed trait that teachers either have or lack, but something that shifts in response to the environment around them. That understanding carries weight beyond theory. It has direct consequences for how schools are run and how policy approaches the question of what it takes to support teachers in their work.

A distinction commonly drawn in the literature is between global and facet-specific satisfaction. Global satisfaction refers to an overall evaluative judgment of one's job, while facet-specific satisfaction refers to attitudes toward particular dimensions such as pay, supervision, colleagues, or the work itself (Wartenberg et al., 2023, p. 3). Both dimensions are relevant to the present study, which examines overall job satisfaction as an outcome variable while also exploring the relative contribution of specific workplace factors as predictors. Pepe et al. (2017) demonstrate that satisfaction facets correlate moderately with one another and with global satisfaction but are not fully congruent. A teacher can, for instance, be satisfied with their relationships with colleagues while simultaneously dissatisfied with student behaviour or parental engagement (pp. 399, 407). This partial independence between facets is theoretically important: it means that improving one dimension of working conditions does not automatically improve overall satisfaction, and that different institutional contexts may produce different satisfaction profiles even among teachers with similar intrinsic motivation.

A further conceptual distinction relevant to this study concerns the difference between satisfaction and dissatisfaction as separate processes. Herzberg, Mausner and Snyderman (1959), elaborated in the teaching context by Dinham and Scott (1998), propose that intrinsic motivator factors such as the nature of the work itself, professional achievement, and a sense of purpose generate satisfaction when present, while extrinsic hygiene factors including salary, working conditions, and job security primarily produce dissatisfaction when perceived as inadequate (Dinham & Scott, 1998, p. 363). This distinction carries a specific implication that is often overlooked in policy discussions: improving extrinsic conditions may reduce dissatisfaction without generating active satisfaction, while eroding

intrinsic rewards may undermine teachers' motivation even when basic conditions are acceptable. In comparative research across school systems with different institutional arrangements as in the present study, this distinction matters considerably, because the two systems may frustrate hygiene needs to different degrees while offering similar intrinsic rewards.

A complementary account comes from SDT (Self-Determination Theory), which locates the roots of motivation and wellbeing in three basic psychological needs: autonomy, competence, and relatedness (Ryan & Deci, 2000, pp. 54, 58–60, 63–64). The argument is straightforward — when teachers have room to exercise professional judgement, opportunities to grow in their practice, and relationships with colleagues that feel genuinely supportive, their motivation tends to be self-sustaining rather than merely compliance-driven. When those same needs go unmet — when work feels controlled rather than chosen, when development stagnates, when professional life is isolating — satisfaction erodes. Where Herzberg identifies what conditions matter, SDT goes a step further and explains why they matter by tracing the psychological pathways through which extrinsic conditions reach inward and affect intrinsic motivation. That level of specificity is something Herzberg's original framework does not offer, which is precisely what makes SDT a productive complement rather than simply an alternative.

2.2 Factors Influencing Teacher Job Satisfaction

A substantial body of international and comparative research has examined the specific workplace and professional factors associated with teacher job satisfaction. Studies conducted across diverse national contexts consistently identify school-level organisational conditions as the primary drivers of satisfaction, with individual teacher characteristics playing a secondary and more variable role (Eryilmaz et al., 2025b, p. 10). The sections below review what the research says about each factor this study looks at, including where the evidence is strong and where gaps remain.

2.2.1 Leadership Support

School leadership is one of the most consistently and strongly documented predictors of teacher job satisfaction across international research. Bellibaş et al. (2025) pulled together 39 studies covering more than 170,000 participants and found that leadership style has a real and measurable relationship with how satisfied teachers feel in their work. Empowering leadership showed the strongest association ($r = 0.58$), followed by servant leadership ($r = 0.54$), then distributed ($r = 0.48$) and transformational leadership ($r = 0.48$) (pp. 11–13). The thread running through all four is fairly clear: the more agency teachers are given, the better. Transactional leadership, which operates through rewards and sanctions rather than professional trust, showed almost no meaningful association with satisfaction ($r = 0.19$) — a finding that sits comfortably with the broader pattern: compliance-based management does not translate into teacher wellbeing (Bellibaş et al., 2025, p. 13).

That said, the evidence is not without its complications. Eryilmaz et al. (2025b) drew on Teaching and Learning International Survey (TALIS) data across 46 countries and found that leadership support predicted satisfaction in only 27 of them — in the remaining cases, the relationship simply did not materialise (pp. 5, 9). Toropova et al. (2021) found something comparable in a Swedish context, where leadership support lost its significance once other working conditions were brought into the analysis (p. 85). The meta-analytic evidence from Bellibaş et al. is broad and carries real weight, but these

findings are a reminder that leadership does not operate the same way everywhere — context shapes how much it actually matters.

These findings raise an important analytical question: is leadership a direct and universal driver of satisfaction, or is its effect contingent on institutional context and mediated by the working conditions that effective leadership creates? This distinction matters for the present study, which examines leadership across two institutional contexts — English Medium and National Curriculum schools. They differ substantially in their management structures and governance arrangements. A leadership effect present in the combined sample may operate through different mechanisms in each system.

What the evidence does establish clearly is the durability of the leadership-satisfaction link under systemic pressure. Eryilmaz, Bellibaş and Berkovich (2025a), analysing TALIS 2013 and 2018 data from 31 countries, found that despite a significant overall decline in teacher job satisfaction across the period, the positive association between distributed leadership and workplace satisfaction remained stable (p. 8). This suggests that effective leadership functions as a structural buffer against the erosion of satisfaction under broader systemic pressures. This finding has direct relevance to Bangladesh, where school systems are undergoing rapid expansion and policy change. In a context where National Curriculum schools often operate under hierarchical management arrangements that leave teachers little room for professional input, the stability of the leadership-satisfaction link across systems and over time suggests that investing in more participative school management is not peripheral — it is one of the more durable levers available.

2.2.2 Workload and Stress

Workload is one of the most reliably documented sources of teacher dissatisfaction, though the evidence rewards closer reading than a straightforward summary might suggest. Eryilmaz et al. (2025b) found a negative relationship between workload and satisfaction in 37 of the 46 countries in their TALIS 2019 sample, with excessive demands feeding into emotional exhaustion and a greater likelihood of teachers considering leaving the profession (p. 9). Admiraal (2025), working with a sample of 77,285 teachers across 24 European countries, found that schools marked by widespread distress and overburden showed consistently lower satisfaction levels (p. 488). The South Asian picture is sharper still. Rabbi (2026) found that nearly three quarters of teachers in Khulna, Bangladesh were working more than 50 hours per week, with 63% reporting high emotional exhaustion — and a strong relationship between that exhaustion and intentions to leave (pp. 147–148).

Yet Klassen and Chiu (2010) introduce a complication that deserves attention. While classroom stress from student misbehaviour was negatively associated with both self-efficacy and satisfaction (pp. 741, 748), workload stress was unexpectedly linked to higher classroom management self-efficacy among some teachers, possibly because heavily loaded teachers over-prepare to maintain control (p. 746). Workload, then, does not hit all teachers in the same way. How much it affects satisfaction seems to depend on what else teachers have access to — things like a strong sense of their own efficacy or reliable support from colleagues can change the equation considerably. Dorji et al. (2025) add another layer to this, finding that among Bhutanese teachers, workload and responsibilities was the strongest predictor of job satisfaction ($\beta = .495$, $p < .05$), ahead of teacher preparation, amenities, and performance management — suggesting that the sheer volume and nature of duties carries particular weight in how teachers experience their work overall (pp. 12–13). That distinction matters — not all workload is the same, and collapsing it into a single measure risks missing where the real strain is coming from. For this study, that is worth keeping in mind. A composite measure of workload and

stress may give a general picture, but it may not be sensitive enough to capture the specific pressures Bangladeshi teachers face across two institutionally quite different school systems.

2.2.3 Pay and Benefits

Financial compensation is foundational to teacher job satisfaction in low- and middle-income country contexts in a way that high-income country research tends to understate. Bennell and Akyeampong (2007) found that teachers in most low-income countries studied, including Bangladesh, earned poverty-level wages of between $2 and $4 per day, with inadequate pay forcing many into secondary employment that divided their professional attention and commitment (pp. 33, 54). This economic reality generates a qualitatively different relationship between pay and satisfaction than the one documented in affluent contexts — not a matter of preference or relative comparison, but of basic financial security and professional dignity.

Higher salaries do not automatically mean happier teachers — what seems to matter more is whether teachers feel fairly compensated and whether their position carries a degree of institutional stability. Hussain et al. (2022) found that public school teachers in Pakistan reported significantly higher satisfaction than their private school counterparts (p. 4), despite the latter sometimes earning higher nominal salaries — a finding the authors attribute to the combined effects of job security, resource availability, and institutional integrity rather than pay alone. Noori (2023) documents a complementary pattern in Afghanistan, where private school teachers reported higher satisfaction in most dimensions but lower satisfaction regarding job security, which the author attributed to the temporary and precarious nature of private employment (pp. 9–10). Together these findings challenge a simple income-maximising model of pay satisfaction and suggest that what teachers value is not just how much they are paid, but the reliability, fairness, and institutional respect that salary structures communicate. This distinction is directly relevant to the Bangladeshi context, where salary structures, employment terms, and job security differ substantially between English Medium and National Curriculum schools. Here the question is not simply who earns more, but who experiences greater financial security and professional recognition through their compensation arrangements.

2.2.4 Working Conditions and Resources

The physical and organisational environment of schools shapes teachers' daily professional experiences in ways that are often analytically distinct from salary and leadership but interact with both. Masoom (2021), studying 368 teachers across primary and secondary schools in Dhaka, found that workgroup encouragement and the relationship with the school principal were the most critical conducive factors in teachers' professional environments, while disruptive students and unreasonable administrative deadlines were the primary toxic factors (pp. 1, 5). Masoom suggests, drawing on prior research, that working conditions including administrative support, school facilities, and class size — may in some contexts be more significant to teachers than salary or student demographics (p. 1). This is a claim that challenges the assumption that pay dominates teacher retention decisions universally.

The evidence from low-income country contexts adds important texture. Gamero Burón and Lassibille (2016), studying 2,695 teachers in Madagascar, found that the difficulty of collecting wages , including travel distances and payment delays had a greater negative impact on satisfaction than the actual salary level itself (pp. 1635, 1641). This finding is analytically significant: it suggests that in resource-constrained settings, the administrative and logistical dimensions of working conditions can compound financial dissatisfaction in ways that go undetected in studies focused on salary alone. For

Bangladesh, where salary payment delays have been documented as a concern for teachers outside the MPO framework, this compound effect may be particularly relevant. The present study cannot fully disentangle these administrative conditions from salary satisfaction given the composite nature of the pay and benefits scale, but the possibility that working conditions amplify or attenuate financial dissatisfaction is worth acknowledging in the interpretation of results.

2.2.5 Collegial Relationships and Autonomy

Positive collegial relationships and professional autonomy consistently emerge as independent predictors of teacher satisfaction, but the evidence suggests their effects may operate through different mechanisms and respond differently to institutional context. Admiraal (2025) found that participative and collaborative school climates positively predicted satisfaction across 24 European countries (p. 488), while Addimando (2019) demonstrated in the Swiss context that supportive work environments were associated with stronger engagement and more varied teaching practice. These findings are consistent with SDT's proposition that relatedness — the experience of genuine connection with colleagues — is a basic psychological need whose fulfilment supports autonomous motivation (Ryan & Deci, 2000, pp. 61–64). However, both studies are rooted in European contexts, which raises a reasonable question: does collegial culture work the same way in South Asian settings, where hierarchical structures and more formal professional boundaries may shape how teachers actually relate to one another?

Autonomy presents a related but analytically distinct case. Park et al. (2020), analysing data from two large US national surveys (N = 14,560 and N = 12,530), found that teacher influence over instructional decisions was more strongly linked to professional commitment, while influence over managerial decisions was more strongly associated with job satisfaction (pp. 125–127). This distinction between instructional and managerial autonomy is conceptually important because it suggests that blanket measures of professional autonomy may conflate dimensions that affect satisfaction through different pathways. In contexts such as Bangladesh, where hierarchical management structures in National Curriculum schools may restrict teacher influence over both instructional and administrative decisions, this distinction may help explain why autonomy, despite its theoretical centrality in SDT does not always emerge as a significant empirical predictor in developing-country samples. A two-item autonomy scale, as used in the present study, is unlikely to capture this complexity fully, a limitation discussed further in Section 6.5.

2.2.6 Student Behaviour and Intrinsic Satisfaction

The intrinsic rewards of teaching — student progress, meaningful relationships, the experience of professional purpose — are among the most powerful and theoretically most significant sources of teacher satisfaction, yet they are also among the most difficult to protect through policy intervention. Dinham and Scott (1998) propose that intrinsic factors related to teaching itself constitute the most stable and enduring source of satisfaction, closely tied to professional identity and more resistant to erosion by institutional conditions than school-level or system-level factors (pp. 365, 375–376). Wartenberg et al.'s (2023) meta-analysis supports this proposition at scale, documenting a positive relationship between satisfaction and both student motivation ($r = 0.29$) and student achievement ($r = 0.10$) across 61 studies (pp. 16–17), a reciprocal dynamic in which meaningful teaching sustains satisfaction, and satisfaction in turn creates better conditions for student learning.

Disruptive student behaviour complicates this picture. Klassen and Chiu (2010) found that classroom stress from misbehaviour was negatively associated with self-efficacy and satisfaction (pp. 741, 747–748), while Masoom (2021) identified disruptive students as the primary toxic factor in Dhaka teachers' professional environments (pp. 1, 5). The evidence thus points to a dual dynamic in which the classroom is simultaneously the primary source of satisfaction and a significant potential source of stress, a tension that institutional conditions either mitigate or amplify. Where school leadership is supportive and collegial relationships are strong, teachers may be better equipped to sustain intrinsic motivation through behavioural challenges. Where these conditions are absent, the same challenges may erode the intrinsic rewards that differentiate teaching from other professional occupations. This interaction between intrinsic satisfaction and school-level conditions is theoretically important but difficult to test in a cross-sectional design and represents a direction for future research.

2.2.7 Job Satisfaction and Intention to Stay or Leave

The relationship between job satisfaction and turnover intentions is among the most robustly documented in the teacher wellbeing literature, yet important questions remain about the magnitude and consistency of this relationship across contexts. Madigan and Kim (2021) synthesised data from 24 studies involving 10,520 teachers and found that burnout and satisfaction together accounted for 27% of the variance in turnover intentions, with satisfaction showing a medium negative relationship with the likelihood of leaving ($r^{+} = -0.40$) (p. 9). Wartenberg et al. (2023) reach a similar conclusion across a larger base of 61 studies, finding a negative association of comparable strength ($r = -0.46$) — an effect size large enough to carry real consequences for how schools plan and manage their workforce (pp. 16–17, 19). Perhaps the most sobering detail in Madigan and Kim's analysis is the trajectory: the burnout-turnover relationship grew significantly stronger over the 35-year period of their study (pp. 7, 10), pointing to a profession whose psychological demands are quietly intensifying — and with them, the risk of losing teachers altogether.

However, the mechanisms driving this relationship are not straightforward. Mertler (2016) found that salary ranked as the top reason 70.9% of Arizona teachers cited for considering leaving, despite placing only tenth as a daily motivator. Herzberg's two-factor framework helps explain this: pay functions as a hygiene factor whose inadequacy generates the pull toward departure without a corresponding capacity to generate active engagement when present (pp. 41–42). Björk et al. (2019) offer a further nuance, identifying four distinct work situation profiles among 328 beginning Swedish teachers and finding that those in environments with adequate resources and manageable demands reported not only higher satisfaction but stronger commitment to remain — implying that satisfaction and retention may be driven by overlapping but not identical workplace conditions (pp. 962–965). For the present study, this means that the factors predicting overall satisfaction (RQ2) and those predicting intention to leave (RQ3) may differ.

This body of evidence directly informs Research Question 3, which examines the relationship between satisfaction and turnover intentions across the two school systems. In the Bangladeshi context, where teacher retention is an ongoing concern and the conditions shaping attrition remain poorly understood, identifying which dimensions of professional experience most strongly predict withdrawal cognitions has direct practical value.

2.3 Teacher Job Satisfaction in Bangladesh: Existing Evidence and Research Gaps

Despite growing recognition of how much teacher satisfaction matters for educational quality, empirical research in Bangladesh remains narrow in both scope and comparative ambition. Most existing studies have focused on teachers within the National Curriculum system, leaving English-medium schoolteachers almost entirely unexamined — a gap that is difficult to justify given how rapidly this sector has grown and how significant its institutional presence has become in urban Bangladesh.

The system within which these teachers work is itself worth understanding. Bangladesh's school education is not a single, coherent structure but a layered, multi-stream arrangement that has shifted considerably since independence in 1971. Mousumi and Kusakabe (2021) describe a system deeply fragmented across National Curriculum, English-medium, and Madrasa streams — a fragmentation that effectively sorts children into divergent educational trajectories along socioeconomic lines (pp. 452-453). The headline enrolment figures tell one part of the story: net enrolment at primary level reached 97.97% in 2017. But they obscure another — only around half of children who begin Grade 1 go on to complete Grade 10 (pp. 453-454). Beneath these numbers sit familiar and stubborn problems: corruption, an exam-driven pedagogy that crowds out genuine learning, and teacher management systems that have long struggled to retain and develop capable practitioners. It is within this environment that English-medium schools have carved out a space as a market-driven alternative to the national system. Mousumi and Kusakabe (2017) characterise this growth as driven by a symmetrical relationship between strategic school supply and parental demand, with parents rejecting mainstream Bangla-medium schools due to perceived quality deficiencies including exam paper leakage, rote-learning pedagogy, and poor infrastructure and viewing English-medium education as a transnational credential and passport to social and economic privilege (pp. 679, 683, 688, 690). This institutional divergence between school systems creates materially different professional environments for teachers, which existing research has almost entirely failed to examine.

Among the few studies that have examined school-level teacher satisfaction in Bangladesh, Ahamed et al. (2013) found that job satisfaction among public primary school teachers varied significantly by demographic profile — female teachers, married teachers, those with humanities backgrounds, those with moderate academic results, and those with more than five years of experience all reported higher satisfaction levels, while poor salary emerged as a widely shared grievance (pp. 234–236). Akter and Alam (2023) found that occupational stress weighed heavily on satisfaction among primary teachers, with structural factors — age, gender, transfer facilities, and promotional policy — each playing a meaningful role in how teachers experienced their work (pp. 15–16). Tasnim (2006), drawing on a mixed-methods study of 57 primary school teachers, found dissatisfaction running across both urban and rural contexts, though what drove it differed. Rural teachers pointed to poor infrastructure and the burden of difficult commutes, while more highly educated teachers expressed a deeper frustration — one that likely reflects the mismatch between what they had trained for and what primary school life actually offers in terms of professional opportunity (pp. 47, 61–78). Masoom (2021) offers a more recent perspective, finding that workgroup encouragement and principal relationships were what teachers in Dhaka schools associated most with a positive work environment, while disruptive student behaviour and unreasonable administrative demands were the conditions that wore satisfaction down most (pp. 1, 5).

At the secondary and higher level, Rabbi (2026) found that 74% of teachers in Khulna reported working more than 50 hours per week, with 63% experiencing high levels of emotional exhaustion and 28% planning to leave the profession within the next year, citing low pay, burnout, and lack of professional growth opportunities (pp. 147–151). Private school teachers in the Khulna study reported higher burnout scores and lower personal accomplishment compared to their public-school counterparts (p. 150-151), a finding that offers a tentative indication of sector-based differences in professional experience — though the study focused on burnout and attrition rather than comparative satisfaction across school systems. This is a significant limitation: Rabbi's data hint at sector-based differences that are directly relevant to the present study's comparative question, yet the study's design does not permit systematic comparison of satisfaction across school types. The present study fills exactly this gap.

While studies examining job satisfaction at the university level in Bangladesh have grown in recent years (Zebon et al., 2025; Masum et al., 2015), school-level research remains substantially underrepresented. Zebon et al. (2025), in a structural equation modelling study of 95 university teachers, found that leadership, career growth, and collegial relationships were the significant predictors of satisfaction, while salary was not statistically significant in their sample (pp. 12, 15). This finding is notable not because it contradicts the school-level evidence, but because it illustrates how strongly institutional context shapes which factors matter — the professional culture, career structures, and salary arrangements at the tertiary level are sufficiently different from those in school settings that findings cannot be transferred across levels without significant caution.

Several important gaps emerge from this review. First, existing Bangladesh research has focused almost exclusively on National Curriculum schools, particularly public primary institutions, leaving English-medium schoolteachers entirely absent from the empirical literature. Second, no study has systematically compared job satisfaction between English-medium and National Curriculum teachers using a common measurement framework, despite the institutional, curricular, and employment condition differences between these systems that would logically be expected to produce different satisfaction profiles. Third, while individual factor analyses exist, fewer studies have examined how multiple workplace factors jointly predict satisfaction or how satisfaction relates to teachers' intention to remain in the profession within the specific dual-system context of urban Bangladesh. The present study directly addresses all three gaps by adopting a comparative quantitative strategy using the adapted Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire as a common measurement instrument across both groups.

2.4 Summary

The literature reviewed in this chapter reveals a consistent but contextually complex picture of teacher job satisfaction. School-level organisational conditions, particularly leadership quality, pay, working conditions, and collegial relationships are the primary drivers of satisfaction across diverse national settings, with individual teacher characteristics playing a secondary role. Intrinsic satisfaction from teaching itself operates as a distinct and durable source of professional wellbeing, one that institutional conditions can protect or erode but cannot fully substitute for. The relationship between satisfaction and turnover intentions is well established, though the specific workplace conditions that predict departure may differ from those that predict satisfaction, a pattern confirmed in the present study's own results.

Critically, the existing literature is not uniform in its findings. The effect of leadership varies across national contexts. The relationship between workload and satisfaction depends on the source and type of demand. The pay-satisfaction relationship is mediated by perceptions of fairness and institutional stability rather than income alone. These nuances matter because they indicate that the satisfaction determinants identified in high-income or single-system studies cannot be assumed to transfer directly to Bangladesh's dual-system context. The present study addresses this by examining which factors predict satisfaction and which predict turnover intentions, in a sample that spans two institutionally distinct school systems within the same national context, using a common measurement framework that enables direct comparison for the first time.

Chapter 3: Theoretical and Analytical Framework

This chapter presents the theoretical perspectives that inform the present study and explains how they are applied in the design, analysis, and interpretation of the research. Following the supervisor's guidance, the conceptualisation of job satisfaction as a construct has been addressed in Chapter 2. The purpose of this chapter is therefore to clarify the theoretical frameworks that guide the operationalisation of key variables, the interpretation of findings, and the analytical approach used to examine relationships between workplace factors, job satisfaction, and teachers' intention to remain in the profession. The chapter draws on three established frameworks: Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory (Herzberg, Mausner, & Snyderman, 1959), Dinham and Scott's Three-Domain Model of Teacher Satisfaction (Dinham & Scott, 1998), and Self-Determination Theory (Ryan & Deci, 2000). Together, these frameworks provide a theoretically grounded basis for the conceptual framework and the analytical decisions made in this study.

3.1 Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory

Herzberg's two-factor theory remains one of the most reached-for frameworks when researchers try to make sense of job satisfaction and motivation at work. The core argument, put forward by Herzberg et al. (1959), is that satisfaction and dissatisfaction are not simply opposite ends of the same scale — they are driven by fundamentally different things. Motivator factors, which include achievement, recognition, responsibility, the nature of the work itself, and room for advancement, tend to generate satisfaction when they are present. Hygiene factors — salary, supervision, working conditions, job security — work differently. When they fall short, dissatisfaction follows. But when they are adequate, they do not produce satisfaction so much as prevent dissatisfaction (Herzberg et al., 1959, as cited in Dinham & Scott, 1998, p. 363).

For a profession like teaching, this distinction is more than theoretical. It implies that fixing external conditions — raising salaries, improving facilities — may take the edge off dissatisfaction without doing much to deepen teachers' engagement or commitment. At the same time, if the intrinsic rewards of teaching erode, motivation can suffer even when the basics are in place. Dinham and Scott (1998) point to this as an explanation for something that might otherwise seem contradictory — teachers who genuinely value their work while also expressing real dissatisfaction with many of the conditions surrounding it (pp. 13–15).

However, it is important to acknowledge that Herzberg's two-factor theory has attracted significant methodological criticism. The theory was originally derived from the critical incident method, which asks workers to recall specific positive and negative experiences at work — a technique that may systematically favour intrinsic factors in recollections of satisfaction and extrinsic factors in recollections of dissatisfaction, thereby artificially producing the two-factor structure (Dinham & Scott, 1998, p. 363). Despite these limitations, the theory's fundamental distinction between intrinsic and extrinsic sources of satisfaction remains analytically useful, and has been widely applied in teacher satisfaction research (Mertler, 2016, p. 43; Zembylas & Papanastasiou, 2004, p. 370).

Herzberg's framework directly informs the operationalisation of the questionnaire used in this study. The adapted Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (TJSQ) distinguishes between intrinsic satisfaction items — captured in Section E (Work Itself) — and extrinsic satisfaction items — captured across Sections C and D, which measure leadership support, pay and benefits, working conditions, workload, and autonomy. This structure reflects Herzberg's distinction between motivator and hygiene factors and enables the regression analysis in Chapter 5 to examine which types of factors , intrinsic or extrinsic most strongly predict overall job satisfaction in each school system. The theory also guides the interpretation of findings in Chapter 6, where differences in satisfaction between English-medium and National Curriculum teachers are discussed in relation to the differing institutional environments that shape both intrinsic rewards and extrinsic conditions in each system.

3.2 Dinham and Scott's Three-Domain Model of Teacher Satisfaction

Dinham and Scott (1998) took the logic of Herzberg's two-factor distinction and applied it directly to the teaching profession, developing a framework that organises the sources of teacher job satisfaction across three distinct domains. The first of these centres on the intrinsic experience of teaching itself — the relationships teachers build with students, the sense of professional accomplishment that comes from effective practice, and the feeling that their work makes a meaningful difference in young people's lives. Dinham and Scott argue that these intrinsic aspects are typically the strongest sources of teacher satisfaction and are closely bound to professional identity. The second domain consists of *school-level factors* — including leadership practices, collegial relationships, workload organisation, and resource availability — which shape teachers' everyday working experiences and can either support or undermine the satisfaction derived from teaching itself (Dinham & Scott, 1998, pp. 375–376). The third domain involves *system-level and societal factors* — including education policies, accountability mechanisms, public expectations, and broader employment conditions — which act on teacher satisfaction from outside the immediate school context (Dinham & Scott, 1998, pp. 375–376).

An important contribution of Dinham and Scott's model is its emphasis on the distinction between satisfaction and dissatisfaction as separate processes operating through different domains. Intrinsic factors in Domain 1 are primarily sources of satisfaction, while Domains 2 and 3 — school-level and system-level conditions — are more frequently associated with dissatisfaction when perceived as inadequate (Dinham & Scott, 1998, pp. 375–376). This explains why teachers may simultaneously report strong intrinsic commitment to teaching while expressing dissatisfaction with institutional working conditions — a pattern theorised within self-determination theory as reflecting the independence of intrinsic motivation from extrinsic contextual factors (Ryan & Deci, 2000, pp. 54–56), and empirically documented among teachers across national contexts (Skaalvik & Skaalvik, 2011, p. 1030) — and one that is particularly relevant to the Bangladeshi context, where challenging extrinsic conditions coexist with teachers' reported intrinsic motivation.

Dinham and Scott's three-domain model does not just inform this study conceptually — it directly shapes how the analysis is structured. The first domain maps onto the Work Itself subscale in the questionnaire, which gets at how satisfied teachers feel with the daily realities of teaching — the classroom work, the student interaction, the things that sit at the heart of the profession. The second domain corresponds to the school-level predictors examined in the multiple regression analysis: leadership support, working conditions and resources, pay and benefits, autonomy, recognition and respect, and collegial relationships. The third domain is partially reflected in the system and societal

factors subscale. Beyond structuring the questionnaire, this three-domain logic also runs through the interpretation of the t-test results in Research Question 1. When differences in overall satisfaction between English-medium and National Curriculum teachers are discussed, the framework provides the scaffolding — pointing toward the school-level and system-level conditions that differ across the two institutional contexts as a way of making sense of what the numbers show.

3.3 Self-Determination Theory

Self-determination theory (SDT), developed by Ryan and Deci (2000), offers a complementary and theoretically important perspective on the motivational underpinnings of job satisfaction. SDT proposes that human motivation and psychological wellbeing are fundamentally shaped by three basic psychological needs: *autonomy* — the experience of volition and self-endorsement in one's actions; *competence* — the feeling of effectiveness and mastery in one's professional role; and *relatedness* — the experience of genuine connection and belonging within one's social environment (Ryan & Deci, 2000, pp. 54, 58-60, 63-64).

A key contribution of SDT that is directly relevant to this study is its distinction between intrinsic and extrinsic motivation and the concept of a continuum of autonomy. Intrinsic motivation — characterised by engaging in activities for their inherent interest and enjoyment — is sustained when individuals feel both competent and autonomous (Ryan & Deci, 2000, p. 58). Extrinsic motivation, by contrast, ranges from fully controlled forms — such as acting under threat or reward — to more autonomous forms that are internalised and integrated into the self, such as professional commitment arising from a deeply held sense of purpose (Ryan & Deci, 2000, pp. 61–62). Extrinsic motivation is not a single thing — it comes in different forms, and the form it takes matters. When teachers act out of genuine professional identification rather than external pressure, the outcomes look markedly different. When these needs are met, the effects are tangible — greater engagement, stronger performance, and better psychological wellbeing tend to follow (Ryan & Deci, 2000, p. 63).

Teaching is a profession where this tension plays out in particularly visible ways. On one side sit the intrinsic rewards — the satisfaction of watching students grow, the relationships built over time, the intellectual life the work affords. On the other sit the extrinsic conditions — salary, institutional support, accountability structures — that can either feed or slowly hollow out a teacher's sense of autonomy, competence, and connection to others. SDT helps explain how these two sides interact. When working conditions meet teachers' basic psychological needs, autonomous motivation tends to follow, and with it, sustained satisfaction. When those same conditions frustrate those needs — through workloads that never ease, management that leaves no room for professional judgment, or resources that fall consistently short — motivation shifts toward something more controlled and brittle. Satisfaction drops, and the risk of burnout and withdrawal grows considerably (Madigan & Kim, 2021, pp. 9–10; Skaalvik & Skaalvik, 2011, pp. 1030–1031, 1035–1036).

SDT informs the interpretation of differences between English-medium and National Curriculum school teachers in two specific ways. First, the need for *autonomy* is operationalised through the autonomy subscale of the questionnaire, which examines teachers' sense of professional discretion in their teaching role. Second, the need for *competence* and *relatedness* is captured indirectly through the Work Itself, Collegial Relationships, and Recognition and Respect subscales. The regression results in Chapter 5 are interpreted in light of SDT's prediction that factors supporting basic psychological need satisfaction . Particularly autonomy, supportive leadership, and collegial relationships will be the strongest positive predictors of overall job satisfaction. Where English-medium and National

Curriculum schools differ in the extent to which they provide environments that support or frustrate these needs, SDT provides a theoretical basis for expecting differential satisfaction levels between the two groups.

3.4 Conceptual and Analytical Framework of the Present Study

Based on the three theoretical perspectives discussed above, this study adopts both a conceptual framework which maps the expected relationships between variables and an analytical framework — which specifies how those relationships are examined through statistical methods.

Conceptually, the study treats teacher job satisfaction as a multidimensional outcome variable shaped by a set of intrinsic and extrinsic workplace factors. Drawing on Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory and Dinham and Scott's Three-Domain Model, workplace factors are grouped into two broad categories: intrinsic factors (work itself) and extrinsic factors (leadership support, pay and benefits, working conditions, autonomy, recognition and respect, collegial relationships, and workload and stress). Overall job satisfaction is conceptualised as a central outcome variable reflecting teachers' cumulative affective evaluation of their professional experience. In line with Skaalvik and Skaalvik (2011, pp. 1029–1031, 1035–1036) and consistent with SDT's theoretical propositions, job satisfaction is expected to influence teachers' intention to remain in or leave the profession. The directional relationships proposed in the conceptual framework are illustrated in Figure 1.

Analytically, this framework is operationalised through three statistical procedures, each corresponding to one of the study's research questions. First, independent-samples t-tests are used to examine whether significant differences exist in overall job satisfaction between English-medium and National Curriculum teachers (Research Question 1) — a procedure justified by the need to compare means across two independent groups. Second, multiple regression analysis is used to identify which workplace and professional factors significantly predict overall job satisfaction — addressing Research Question 2 and reflecting the multi-factor logic that runs through all three theoretical frameworks. Third, the same analytical approach is applied to examine how overall job satisfaction and workplace factors relate to teachers' intention to stay or leave — addressing Research Question 3 and drawing on the theoretical assumption that satisfaction sits between working conditions and retention decisions, mediating the relationship between the two.

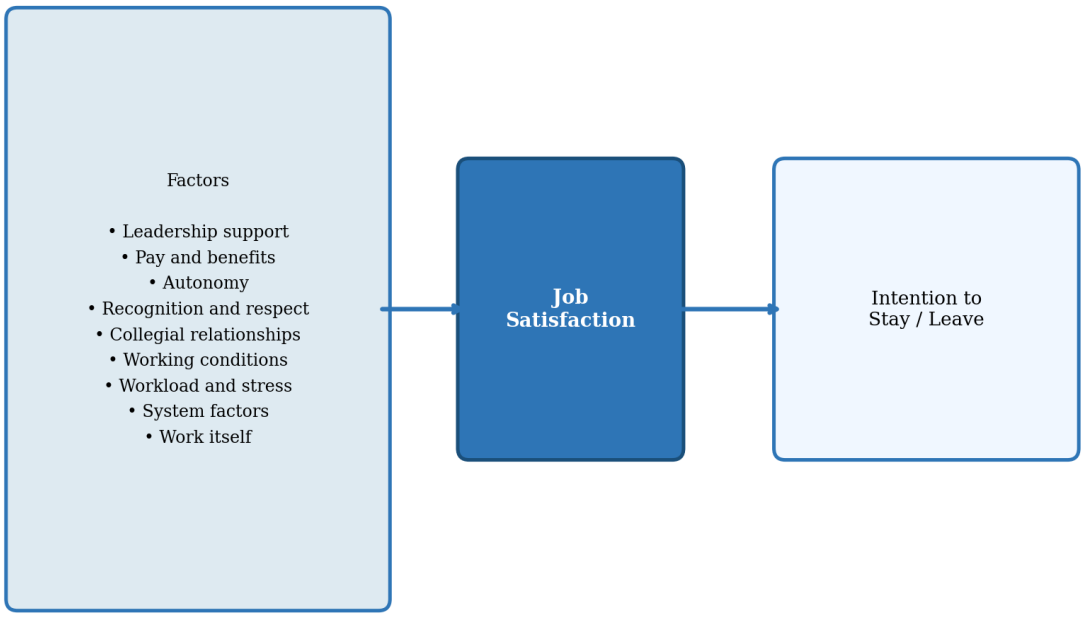


Figure 1. Conceptual Framework of the Study

3.5 Summary

This chapter has outlined the three theoretical frameworks underpinning the present study — Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory, Dinham and Scott's Three-Domain Model, and Self-Determination Theory, and explained how each framework is applied in the study's research design, questionnaire structure, statistical analysis, and interpretation of findings. Together, these frameworks conceptualise teacher job satisfaction as an affective evaluation shaped by intrinsic, school-level, and system-level factors, and position it as a key determinant of teachers' intention to remain in or leave the profession. The next chapter describes the methodological decisions through which these theoretical propositions are empirically examined.

Chapter 4: Methodology

This chapter explains how the study was designed and carried out — from the research paradigm and sampling strategy through to data collection and analysis — in the context of investigating job satisfaction among teachers in English-medium and National Curriculum schools in Bangladesh. Following a quantitative strategy, a structured questionnaire adapted from the Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (TJSQ) was used to collect data within a cross-sectional design.The methodology was designed with two broad purposes in mind: to enable meaningful comparison between the two school systems, and to examine the relationships between workplace factors, job satisfaction, and teachers' intention to stay in or leave the profession. Before the main analysis, a series of preparatory steps were carried out — data screening, reverse coding of negatively worded items, and reliability testing — to ensure the data were in suitable condition for statistical analysis using IBM SPSS Statistics.

4.1 Research Paradigm

A positivist approach suits this study for several reasons. The research questions require comparing job satisfaction levels between two distinct teacher groups and identifying predictive relationships between multiple variables — objectives that call for standardised measurement instruments and statistical techniques capable of supporting systematic comparison (Creswell, 2014). The study also aims to generate empirical evidence relevant to policy and school-level practice, which means the findings need to be replicable and verifiable rather than context-bound and interpretive.

Ontologically, the study treats teacher job satisfaction as something that, while grounded in individual perception and experience, can be operationalised through survey items and examined as a construct with identifiable, consistently measurable dimensions (Bryman, 2012, pp. 164–165). This is not a claim to capture everything — job satisfaction is a subjective state, and individual circumstances and contextual factors will always shape it in ways a questionnaire cannot fully reach. What the approach offers instead is the ability to identify measurable patterns and relationships across two educational contexts in Bangladesh, and thus contributes to a broader empirical picture of what shapes how teachers experience their work.

4.2 Research Design

Data for this study were collected at a single point in time through a structured questionnaire, following a cross-sectional design. This design is well suited to examining current levels of job satisfaction and comparing groups within a specific educational context (Bryman, 2012, pp. 59–60; Creswell, 2014). It is also widely used in educational research precisely because it supports the kind of variable-level analysis the present study requires — comparing group means and identifying predictive relationships through standardised measurement and numerical analysis (Creswell, 2014, p. 155; Bryman, 2012, pp. 164–165).

The structured questionnaire serves two practical purposes here. It allows comparable data to be gathered from a reasonably large number of participants across two school systems, and it supports the statistical techniques — independent-samples t-tests and multiple regression analysis — needed to address the research questions directly. The focus throughout is on comparing job satisfaction between

English-medium and National Curriculum teachers, and on identifying the workplace and professional factors that predict both satisfaction and intention to stay or leave.

4.2.1 Justification for the Quantitative Strategy

Quantitative strategies are particularly suitable when the aim is to examine differences between groups and to identify relationships among multiple variables using numerical data (Bryman, 2012, pp. 160–162).Specifically, this study seeks to (a) compare levels of job satisfaction between teachers working in English Medium and National Curriculum schools; (b) identify which factors significantly predict job satisfaction; and (c) examine the extent to which job satisfaction predicts teachers' intention to remain in or leave the profession. Achieving these aims requires standardised measurement instruments and statistical analysis — tools that sit at the core of quantitative strategy (Creswell, 2014).

Qualitative strategies, while valuable for exploring how individual teachers make sense of their experiences, are less well suited to research questions that call for group-level comparison and the identification of predictive relationships (Bryman, 2012, p. 380). Given the study's focus on two parallel school systems and its need to detect measurable differences and statistically significant patterns across them, a quantitative strategy is the more appropriate fit.

4.3 Population and Sampling

4.3.1 Population

The target population of this study consists of teachers working in English Medium schools and National Curriculum schools in urban areas of Bangladesh. Comparing English-medium and National Curriculum schools makes sense precisely because the two systems are so differently organised — in their curricula, structures, and employment arrangements. Both are predominantly urban, which is why Dhaka and Chattogram were the natural focus; this is where established schools from both systems are found and where recruiting sufficient participants was most feasible.

4.3.2 Sampling Technique

A non-probability sampling strategy, combining purposive and snowball sampling techniques, was used to recruit participants. Purposive sampling involves the deliberate selection of participants based on specific characteristics relevant to the research objectives (Bryman, 2012, p. 418). In this study, teachers were selected based on their employment in either English Medium or National Curriculum schools in urban Bangladesh. Snowball sampling was used as a supplementary technique; whereby initial participants were encouraged to share the survey link with eligible colleagues who met the inclusion criteria. This approach is particularly useful in educational research when access to schools is limited and when formal sampling frames are unavailable (Creswell, 2014). The sampling strategy allowed participants to be recruited across different school contexts, though non-probability sampling means the findings cannot be straightforwardly generalised to the wider population of teachers in Bangladesh.

4.3.3 Sample Size

The study aimed to recruit a minimum of 300 teachers, with approximately 150 drawn from each school type. This target was considered adequate for both group comparison and multiple regression analysis within the scope of a master's thesis, and the final sample met it exactly — 300 teachers in total, providing sufficient statistical power for the planned analyses.

4.4 Research Instrument

Data were collected using a structured, self-administered questionnaire adapted from the Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (TJSQ) developed by Lester (1987). The TJSQ is a widely used instrument in educational research for measuring teacher job satisfaction across multiple dimensions, including supervision, colleagues, working conditions, pay, responsibility, work itself, advancement, security, and recognition (Lester, 1987). The instrument has been validated in various educational contexts and has demonstrated acceptable levels of reliability and construct validity (Lester, 1987; Pepe et al., 2017).

For the purpose of this study, the original TJSQ was modified to reflect the specific context of the Bangladeshi education system. Modifications were done by the addition of items related to workload, emotional exhaustion, and system-level pressures, which have been identified in recent literature as important factors affecting teacher job satisfaction in low- and middle-income countries (Skaalvik & Skaalvik, 2017, p. 154). Items were also reworded to ensure clarity and cultural appropriateness for teachers working in Bangladesh.

The final questionnaire consists of five sections: Section A covers background information, including school type, location, school level taught, gender, age group, highest academic qualification, years of teaching experience, employment status, and monthly salary range. Section B measures overall job satisfaction using four items that assess teachers' general feelings towards their job. Section C covers key workplace and system-level factors, including leadership support, working conditions and resources, pay and benefits, autonomy, recognition and respect, collegial relationships, workload and stress, and system and societal factors. Section D measures intention to stay or leave using four items that assess teachers' intentions to remain in their current school and in the teaching profession. Section E measures work itself (intrinsic satisfaction) with four elements connected to the inherent rewards of teaching.

Sections B through E used a five-point Likert scale running from 1 (Strongly disagree) to 5 (Strongly agree) for attitudinal items A five-point scale was chosen because it gives enough range to capture meaningful differences in response without becoming confusing or burdensome for participants (Bryman, 2012, p. 166). A five-point format is also supported on measurement quality grounds — research comparing agree–disagree scales of different lengths found that five categories yielded higher validity than seven- or eleven-point scales, as longer scales tend to amplify method effects and reduce the accuracy of responses (Revilla et al., 2014, pp. 88–89). Care was taken throughout to make sure the questionnaire read clearly and felt appropriate for teachers in both English-medium and National Curriculum schools in Bangladesh. The full questionnaire is included in Appendix A.

4.5 Data Collection Procedure

Data were collected through an online survey administered via Google Forms between March and April 2026. The online format made practical sense given the geographical spread of participants across multiple urban centres in Bangladesh — it allowed efficient distribution, reduced data entry errors, and meant responses were automatically organised for analysis (Bryman, 2012, pp. 671, 676). The online format allowed participants to complete the questionnaire at a convenient time and place, which was expected to improve response rates and data quality.

Participation in the study was entirely voluntary. An information consent (Appendix A) was provided at the beginning of the survey, explaining the purpose of the study, the estimated completion time, and participants' rights. Informed consent was obtained from all participants prior to their completion of the questionnaire. The participants were informed that their responses would be kept confidential and that no identifying information would be recorded. They were also informed that they could withdraw from the study at any time without any consequences by contacting the researcher.

Participants were selected using purposive sampling, where eligibility criteria determined inclusion, supplemented by snowball sampling, in which initial participants were encouraged to refer eligible colleagues (Emerson, 2015, p. 166). The survey link was distributed through personal contacts in the education sector. Initial participants were also encouraged to share the survey link with eligible colleagues, consistent with the snowball sampling approach described in Section 4.3.

Only teachers currently employed in English-medium or National Curriculum schools in urban Bangladesh were eligible to take part — screening questions at the start of the survey confirmed this before anyone could proceed. In early February 2026, ahead of the main data collection, 30 teachers took part in a pilot — 15 from each school type. The aim was to catch any wording problems or weaknesses in the scale construction early. The pilot study confirmed that the questionnaire was clearly worded and contextually appropriate. Reliability analysis conducted on the pilot data indicated acceptable internal consistency for most scales (see Section 4.6.2), and no items were removed or substantially reworded as a result of the pilot. Based on the pilot study, the estimated time required to complete the questionnaire was approximately six to seven minutes, as determined from the time taken by the pilot respondents.

4.6 Validity and Reliability

4.6.1 Validity

In quantitative strategy, validity refers to the extent to which a research instrument accurately measures the concept it is intended to measure (Bryman, 2012, p. 171). Several steps were taken in this study to ensure the instrument and the data it produced were trustworthy.

The questionnaire was adapted from Lester's (1987) Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (TJSQ), a well-established instrument with a track record in educational research — a starting point that lends the study a degree of content validity from the outset. Items were then reviewed and where necessary reworded to ensure they read clearly and made sense in the Bangladeshi context, without distorting the meaning of the original constructs. Before the main data collection, a pilot study was carried out with 30 teachers. This served a practical purpose — checking that items were clearly understood, that completion time was reasonable, and that the scales held together internally. Reliability analysis at this stage returned acceptable to high internal consistency across most scales, giving enough confidence to proceed with the main data collection. The questionnaire also included reverse-coded items to

discourage automatic or unreflective responding. Together, these measures were intended to produce an instrument that was both conceptually grounded and suitable for the Bangladeshi context.

4.6.2 Reliability Testing — Pilot Study

To assess the internal consistency of the questionnaire, reliability testing was conducted using Cronbach's alpha coefficient. Cronbach's alpha measures the degree to which items within a scale are correlated with one another and therefore measure the same underlying construct (Bryman, 2012, p.170; Field, 2018). In social science research, an alpha value of 0.70 or higher is generally considered acceptable, while values above 0.80 indicate good internal consistency (Field, 2018, p. 826).

Prior to the main data collection, a pilot study was conducted during early February 2026 with 30 teachers (15 teachers from English Medium Schools and 15 teachers from National Curriculum schools) to evaluate the reliability of the questionnaire and identify potential issues with item wording or scale construction. The reliability analysis showed that most scales demonstrated acceptable to excellent internal consistency. The Cronbach's alpha values obtained in the pilot study were as follows: overall job satisfaction ($\alpha = 0.913$), leadership support ($\alpha = 0.642$), working conditions and resources ($\alpha = 0.712$), pay and benefits ($\alpha = 0.974$), recognition and respect ($\alpha = 0.860$), collegial relationships ($\alpha = 0.793$), workload and stress ($\alpha = 0.660$), intention to remain in the profession ($\alpha = 0.884$), and work itself ($\alpha = 0.886$). The autonomy scale showed a lower reliability coefficient ($\alpha = 0.478$), which may be related to the small pilot sample size and the limited number of items within the scale. The items were kept on theoretical grounds — autonomy is central enough to teacher job satisfaction that removing it would have left a meaningful gap. On balance, the pilot study provided sufficient confidence to proceed with the questionnaire in its current form.

4.6.3 Reliability Testing — Main Study

The reliability analysis for the main study data is presented in Table 4.1, which reports the Cronbach's alpha values for each scale. The results indicate the degree to which each set of items consistently measured its intended construct across the full sample of 300 participants.

Table 4.1. Reliability Statistics

Construct	***Cronbach's Alpha***
Overall job satisfaction	0.868
Leadership support	0.779
Working conditions and resources	0.756
Pay and benefits	0.898
Autonomy	0.735
Recognition and respect	0.748
Collegial relationships	0.801

Construct	*Cronbach's Alpha*
Workload and stress	0.625
System and societal factors	−0.441
Intention to leave	0.854
Work itself	0.819

The reliability analysis indicates that most scales demonstrated acceptable to high internal consistency, with Cronbach's alpha values above the commonly recommended threshold of 0.70 (Field, 2018). The Job Satisfaction scale showed particularly strong reliability (α = 0.868), indicating that the items measuring overall satisfaction were highly consistent. The Pay & Benefits scale showed very high reliability (α = 0.898), suggesting that respondents answered consistently across items measuring financial satisfaction and benefits. Similarly, the Intention to Leave scale demonstrated strong reliability (α = 0.854), indicating that the items consistently captured teachers' intentions regarding remaining in or leaving the profession.

The Workload & Stress scale showed moderate reliability (α = 0.625), which may reflect the complexity of workload experiences and variations in teachers' perceptions of work-related stress. However, values above 0.60 are considered acceptable in exploratory social science research, particularly when scales contain a small number of items.

The System and Societal Factors scale yielded a negative reliability coefficient (α = −0.441). Such a result indicates a fundamental measurement problem rather than simply low internal consistency. The negative alpha value most likely resulted from the contradictory directionality of the two items within this scale — one item measuring perceived societal respect for the profession (a positive framing) and one measuring policy-related stress (a negative framing) — which assessed conceptually distinct rather than unified aspects of the construct. To maintain the psychometric integrity of the inferential analyses, this scale was excluded from the subsequent multiple regression models. This ensures that the results for Research Questions 2 and 3 are based solely on variables with demonstrated internal consistency.Overall, the reliability results indicate that the measurement instrument demonstrates acceptable internal consistency and is appropriate for further statistical analysis.

4.6.4 Data Screening and Preparation

After the data collection period was completed, responses were exported from Google Forms into Microsoft Excel and subsequently imported into IBM SPSS Statistics for analysis. Before any statistical analysis began, the dataset was screened for problems. This meant checking for missing values, incomplete responses, and patterns that suggested participants had not been paying attention — identical answers all the way through, for instance. Of the 311 responses received, eleven were removed on these grounds, either because more than 20% of items were left unanswered or because the response pattern was clearly invalid. What remained was a clean dataset of 300 responses — 150 from English-medium school teachers and 150 from National Curriculum school teachers. This balanced sample size ensured comparability between the two groups and provided sufficient statistical power for conducting inferential statistical analyses, including independent samples t-tests and multiple regression analysis.

4.6.5 The Instrument — Reverse Coding and Composite Scores

The instrument was a five-point Likert-scale questionnaire (Appendix A) adapted from the Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (TJSQ) developed by Lester (1987). The Likert scale ranged from 1 = Strongly Disagree, 2 = Disagree, 3 = Neutral, 4 = Agree, and 5 = Strongly Agree.

Several items in the questionnaire were negatively worded to reduce response bias. These items were reverse coded prior to analysis so that higher values consistently reflected higher levels of job satisfaction, stronger perceived support, more favourable working conditions, or greater intention to remain in the profession. For the five-point Likert scale used in this study, reverse coding was performed using the transformation: new value = 6 − original value. As a result, a response of 1 was recoded as 5, 2 as 4, 3 remained unchanged, 4 as 2, and 5 as 1. The items that were reverse-coded included W2, W3, W4 (workload and stress items), S2 (system-level stress item), and IL2, IL3, IL4 (intention to leave items).

Once reverse coding was complete, a mean score was calculated for each construct by averaging the relevant items. Keeping to a mean rather than a sum preserves the original 1 to 5 scale, which makes the results easier to interpret — a score closer to 5 reflects stronger agreement with positive statements, while a score closer to 1 reflects stronger disagreement (Pallant, 2016). The following composite variables were then created: Job Satisfaction (JS_mean) from JS1–JS4; Leadership Support (L_mean) from L1–L2; Working Conditions and Resources (R_mean) from R1–R2; Pay and Benefits (P_mean) from P1–P2; Autonomy (A_mean) from A1–A2; Recognition and Respect (REC_mean) from REC1–REC2; Collegial Relationships (C_mean) from C1–C2; Workload and Stress (W_mean) from W1, W2_R, W3_R, and W4_R; System and Societal Factors (S_mean) from S1 and S2_R; Intention to Leave (IL_mean) from IL1, IL2_R, IL3_R, and IL4_R; and Work Itself (WI_mean) from WI1–WI4. These composite variables fed into the reliability analysis, descriptive statistics, independent samples t-tests, and multiple regression analyses that follow. Getting this preparation right mattered — consistent measurement across variables is what gives the subsequent analysis its validity.

4.7 Ethical Considerations

This study was conducted in line with Swedish research ethics guidelines (Swedish Research Council, 2017) and the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) (European Union, 2016). Given that participants were based in Bangladesh, the ethical principles outlined by the Bangladesh Medical Research Council (BMRC, 2014) were also followed covering voluntary participation, informed consent, confidentiality, and the right to withdraw. These were not treated as procedural checkboxes but were attended to across every stage of the research (Bryman, 2012, p. 135).

Taking part was entirely voluntary. Before accessing the questionnaire, participants received an information statement explaining what the study was about, what their participation would involve, and how the data would be used. They were told that responses would be used solely for academic purposes as part of a master's thesis. Consent was obtained before anyone could proceed, and participants were made aware that they could withdraw at any point without needing to give a reason and without any consequences (Bryman, 2012, pp. 138–141). No pressure was applied and no incentives were offered. The questionnaire did not touch on sensitive personal matters, and participation carried no physical, psychological, or professional risk.

Anonymity was built into the design from the start. The questionnaire collected no personally identifiable information — no names, email addresses, phone numbers, or institutional identifiers. This means individual participants cannot be traced through the dataset. Data were used only for research purposes, kept secure, and accessed only by the researcher. In keeping with GDPR's data minimisation principle, only information directly relevant to the research questions was collected (European Union, 2016). Background details such as school type, teaching experience, and age group were included, but none of these can be used to identify anyone individually. The data will be held securely for as long as the thesis requires and will not be repurposed beyond that.

Participants were also told that responses would only be reported in aggregated form — meaning no individual answer would ever appear on its own. This further reduced any risk of identification, for teachers and schools alike. Given that the survey was anonymous and steered clear of sensitive personal information, the study sits comfortably in the low-risk category. The principles of informed consent, confidentiality, anonymity, voluntary participation, and responsible data handling were maintained throughout (Bryman, 2012).

4.8 Use of Artificial Intelligence Tools

In accordance with the Department of Education's preliminary guidelines on the use of AI in thesis writing, artificial intelligence tools were used in a limited capacity during the preparation of this thesis. Specifically, Grammarly and Claude (Anthropic) were used for language support purposes — including grammar checking, proofreading, improving the clarity of expression, and restructuring sentences for readability. All research design decisions, data collection, SPSS analyses, and the interpretation of findings were conducted independently by the researcher. The analytical processes, arguments, and conclusions presented in this thesis are the researcher's own. No AI tool was used to generate, replace, or conduct any part of the data analysis.

4.9 Summary

This chapter has set out how the study was designed and carried out. A positivist research paradigm was adopted, using a cross-sectional design and a quantitative strategy, with data collected from 300 teachers across English-medium and National Curriculum schools in urban Bangladesh through an adapted version of the Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire. Most scales held up well in reliability testing, the data were screened and prepared carefully before analysis, and ethical principles — voluntary participation, informed consent, anonymity, and confidentiality — were maintained throughout. Chapter 5 moves on to the statistical findings.

Chapter 5: Findings

This chapter presents the results of the statistical analyses conducted to address the research questions of the study. The findings are based on validated data from 300 teachers working in English Medium and National Curriculum schools in urban Bangladesh. The data were analysed using IBM SPSS Statistics program following the procedures described in Chapter 4. The chapter begins with a description of the demographic characteristics of the respondents, followed by descriptive statistics for the main study variables. Inferential statistical analyses were then conducted to answer the research questions. An independent samples t-test was used to examine differences in job satisfaction between the two school types. Multiple regression analyses were conducted to identify the factors related to job satisfaction and to examine the relationship between job satisfaction and teachers' intention to remain in or leave the profession. The results are presented according to each research question and provide the basis for the discussion in the following chapter.

5.1 Demographic Characteristics of Respondents

Descriptive statistical analyses were conducted to understand the demographic composition of the sample, including school type, location, teaching level, gender, age group, educational qualification, years of teaching experience, employment status, and salary range.

Table 5.1. Demographic characteristics of respondents

Variable	***Category***	***Participant number***	***Percentage***
School type	*English Medium*	*150*	*50.0%*
	National Curriculum	*150*	*50.0%*
Location	*Dhaka*	*222*	*74.0%*
	Chattogram	*56*	*18.7%*
	Other city	*22*	*7.3%*
Teaching level	*Primary*	*138*	*46.0%*
	Secondary	*73*	*24.3%*
	Both levels	*89*	*29.7%*
Gender	*Female*	*209*	*69.7%*
	Male	*80*	*26.7%*
	Prefer not to say	*11*	*3.7%*
Age group	*20–29 years*	*96*	*32.0%*

Variable	*Category*	*Participant number*	*Percentage*
	30–39 years	*134*	*44.7%*
	40+ years	*70*	*23.3%*
Education	*Bachelor's degree*	*69*	*23.0%*
	Master's degree	*226*	*75.3%*
	MPhil/PhD	*1*	*0.3%*
	Other	*4*	*1.3%*
Teaching experience	*0–4 years*	*100*	*33.3%*
	5–10 years	*114*	*38.0%*
	10+ years	*86*	*28.7%*
Employment status	*Contract*	*60*	*20.0%*
	Permanent full-time	*219*	*73.0%*
	Permanent part-time	*21*	*7.0%*
Salary range (BDT)	*Less than 25,000*	*120*	*40.0%*
	25,000–45,000	*97*	*32.3%*
	More than 45,000	*60*	*20.0%*
	Prefer not to say	*23*	*7.7%*

The sample consisted of an equal proportion of teachers from English Medium and National Curriculum schools, ensuring balanced representation for comparison. The majority of respondents were located in Dhaka (74%), with a further 18.7% from Chattogram, reflecting the urban focus of the study. The findings therefore primarily represent the experiences of teachers working in Bangladesh's two largest cities rather than the broader national teaching workforce.

Female teachers constituted the majority of the sample (69.7%), a distribution consistent with the pronounced feminisation of the teaching profession in urban Bangladesh, particularly at the primary level (Mousumi & Kusakabe, 2021, pp. 459- 460). The predominance of female respondents is relevant to interpreting satisfaction patterns, since gender has been associated with differential professional experiences in South Asian school systems, and the present sample may not fully capture the experiences of male teachers in either sector. The largest proportion of respondents were aged between 30 and 39 years (44.7%), indicating that the sample is predominantly composed of mid-career teachers, whose satisfaction profiles may differ from those of early-career or near-retirement colleagues. Most teachers held a master's degree (75.3%) which reflects the relatively high formal

qualification levels common among urban school teachers in Bangladesh. Teaching experience was distributed across career stages, with the largest group reporting 5 to 10 years of experience (38%), and a further 28.7% having more than a decade in the profession. A substantial majority were employed on a permanent full-time basis (73%), suggesting that employment precarity was not a dominant feature of the sample — though the 20% on contract arrangements may experience distinctly different levels of job security and associated satisfaction.

The salary distribution warrants particular attention in relation to the findings that follow. Forty percent of teachers in the sample reported monthly earnings below 25,000 BDT, while only 20% earned more than 45,000 BDT. As Figure 2 shows, financial insecurity is not a marginal experience in this sample — it is a fairly common one. That context matters when making sense of the pay dissatisfaction findings in Section 5.2 and the regression results in Sections 5.4 and 5.5.

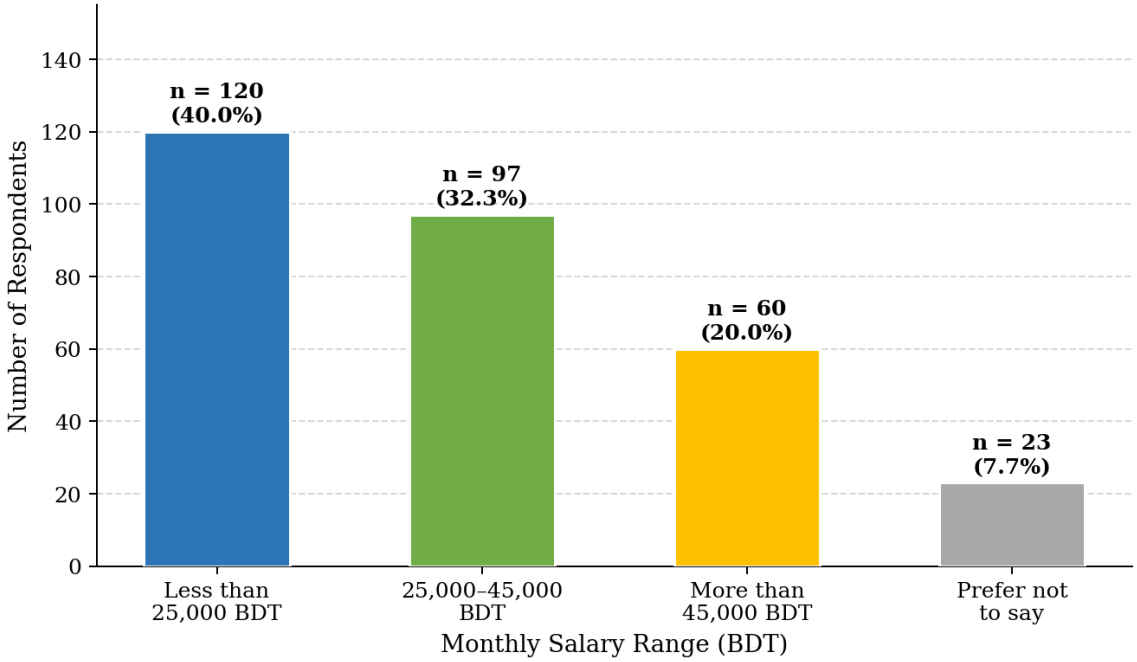


Figure 2. Distribution of respondents by salary range

Taken together, the demographic profile describes a qualified, predominantly female, mid-career sample concentrated in Dhaka, with a salary structure in which a large proportion of teachers face conditions likely to generate financial concern. These characteristics are broadly consistent with existing descriptions of the urban teaching workforce in Bangladesh (Masoom, 2021, pp. 5-6) and provide a meaningful backdrop for the analysis of job satisfaction, workplace predictors, and turnover intentions that follows.

5.2 Descriptive statistics of the study variables

Descriptive statistics were calculated to summarise the central tendency and variability of the key study variables.

Table 5.2. Descriptive statistics of variables

Variable	***Mean***	***Standard deviation***
Overall job satisfaction	*3.508*	*0.874*
Leadership support	*3.352*	*0.860*
Working conditions and resources	*3.560*	*0.864*
Pay and benefits	*2.873*	*1.074*
Autonomy	*3.633*	*0.826*
Recognition and respect	*3.662*	*0.846*
Collegial relationships	*3.802*	*0.796*
Workload and stress	*3.145*	*0.768*
System and societal factors	*2.937*	*0.630*
Intention to leave	*3.273*	*1.098*
Work itself	*3.935*	*0.705*

Overall job satisfaction in the combined sample came in at a mean of 3.51 — moderate, but not particularly high. Within that, two areas stood out. Work itself scored highest (M = 3.94), followed by collegial relationships (M = 3.80), suggesting that teachers generally find the day-to-day work meaningful and feel reasonably positive about their relationships with colleagues. In other words, the intrinsic side of teaching and the social environment of the workplace are holding up better than other areas. Recognition and respect (M = 3.66) and autonomy (M = 3.63) also came in above the midpoint which point to moderately positive perceptions in both domains.

Pay and benefits recorded the lowest mean score of all workplace factors (M = 2.87), falling below the scale midpoint of 3.00. This indicates widespread dissatisfaction with salary and financial compensation across the sample — a finding consistent with the broader literature on teacher pay in low- and middle-income countries (Bennell & Akyeampong, 2007, pp. 33, 54) and directly relevant to the regression findings reported in Section 5.4. System and societal factors also recorded a below-midpoint mean (M = 2.94), suggesting that teachers perceive broader policy and societal conditions as less favourable. Workload and stress levels were moderate (M = 3.15), indicating that teachers experience some degree of work pressure but not at extreme levels. Leadership support showed a mean score of 3.35, indicating moderate perceptions of support from school management, with room for improvement across both school types.

The mean score for intention to leave was 3.27, which is above the scale midpoint, indicating that a meaningful proportion of teachers are considering leaving their current school or the profession. This finding provides the basis for the analysis presented in Section 5.5, which examines the relationship between job satisfaction, workplace factors, and turnover intentions.

The System and societal factors variable showed low internal consistency (α = −0.441) and was therefore excluded from the subsequent regression analyses. All other scales demonstrated acceptable to strong internal consistency as reported in Table 4.1 and are retained in the analyses that follow.

5.3 Overall Job Satisfaction Between English Medium and National Curriculum School Teachers in Bangladesh

Research Question 1 aimed to examine whether there is a statistically significant difference in overall job satisfaction between teachers working in English Medium schools and those working in National Curriculum schools. To address this question, an independent samples *t*-test was conducted using job satisfaction as the dependent variable and school type as the grouping variable.

Table 5.3. Group statistics for job satisfaction

School type	*N*	*Mean*	*Std. deviation*
English Medium	150	3.77	0.70
National Curriculum	150	3.25	0.95

The descriptive results indicate that teachers working in English Medium schools reported higher levels of job satisfaction (M = 3.77) compared to teachers working in National Curriculum schools (M = 3.25). The difference in mean scores suggests that school type may influence teachers' perceptions of their professional experiences and working conditions.

Table 5.3b. Independent samples t-test results for overall job satisfaction

	English Medium (n = 150)	*National Curriculum (n = 150)*	*t*	*df*	*p*	*Cohen's d*
Overall job satisfaction	3.77 (0.70)	3.25 (0.95)	**5.351**	**298**	**< .001**	**0.62**

Note. Values in parentheses are standard deviations. Cohen's d = 0.62 indicates a moderate effect size.

The independent samples t-test confirmed a statistically significant difference in overall job satisfaction between the two groups: t (298) = 5.351, p < .001. Since the p-value is less than the conventional significance level of 0.05, the null hypothesis of no difference between the groups is rejected. The effect size (d = 0.62) indicates a moderate and practically meaningful difference — one that goes beyond statistical significance to reflect a genuine divergence in how teachers across the two systems experience their professional lives. According to Cohen's (1988) conventions, a d value of 0.62 falls within the medium effect size range (d = 0.50–0.79), indicating that the difference between the two groups is not only statistically reliable but substantively important.

The difference is not hard to explain. English-medium schools run as market-oriented institutions — they compete for students and reputation, and that competition creates real pressure to invest in what

teachers are paid, what resources they have, and what their working conditions look like. Fee-paying parental demand drives these schools to maintain standards that attract and retain qualified staff — and salary, working environment, and leadership quality are central to that effort (Mousumi & Kusakabe, 2017, p. 687). National Curriculum schools, particularly those in the non-MPO sector, operate under fundamentally different governance arrangements, with less institutional flexibility to respond to teachers' professional needs and fewer market-based incentives to prioritise teacher wellbeing. English Medium schools may also apply more competitive teacher selection processes and offer structured professional development opportunities as part of their effort to maintain institutional reputation — conditions that further shape how teachers experience their work. The satisfaction gap documented here is the predictable outcome of two systems designed around different logics of accountability and resource allocation.

The notably wider variance in the National Curriculum group (SD = 0.95 versus SD = 0.70 in the English Medium group) is equally telling. It indicates not only that NC teachers report lower satisfaction on average, but that their experiences are far more heterogeneous — some report satisfaction levels comparable to their EM counterparts, while others report considerably lower levels. This variability reflects the structural diversity within the NC sector itself, which encompasses schools ranging from relatively well-resourced urban institutions to severely under-resourced establishments with little state financial support. Treating National Curriculum schools as a homogeneous category, as most prior research has done, obscures as much as it reveals. The spread of scores suggests that the policy challenge within the NC sector is not simply one of raising average satisfaction but of addressing the extreme variation in conditions that produces such different professional experiences for teachers nominally working within the same system.

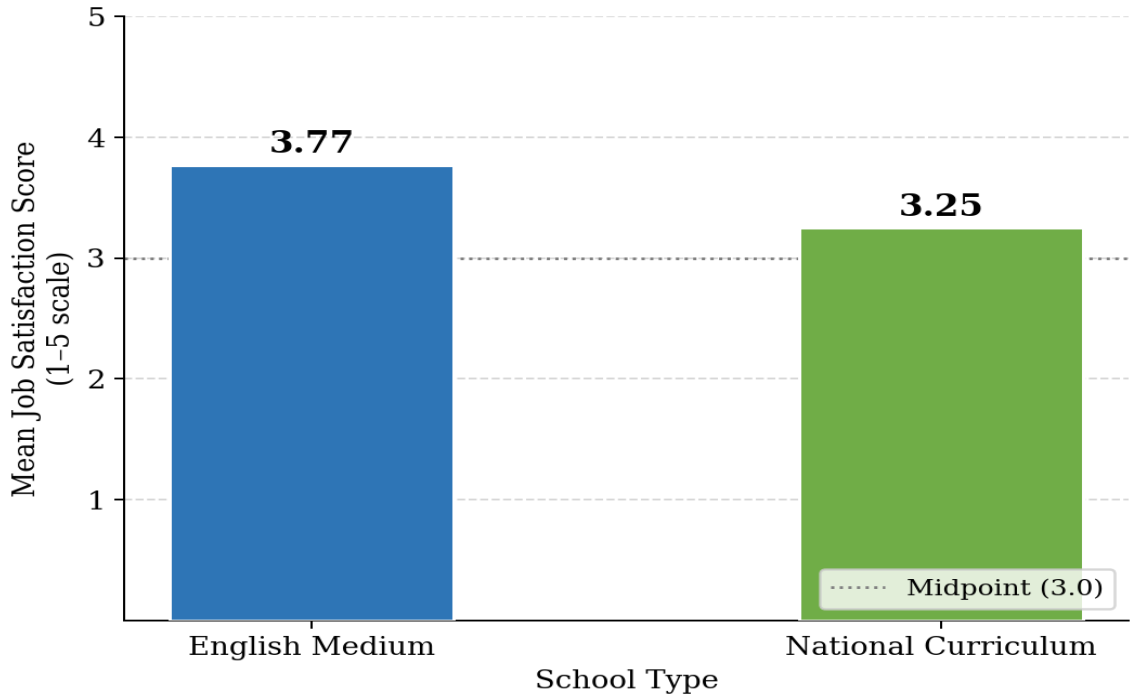


Figure 3. Mean job satisfaction by school type

Figure 3 visually illustrates the difference in mean job satisfaction between the two groups. The gap between the two bars, more than half a scale point represents a difference large enough to have

tangible consequences for professional commitment, instructional engagement, and retention, as the regression analyses in Sections 5.4 and 5.5 subsequently demonstrate. The greater spread of satisfaction scores among National Curriculum teachers, reflected in the wider standard deviation, is not visible in this figure but is an important feature of the data that the descriptive statistics in Table 5.3 capture.

5.4 Factors Related to Teacher Job Satisfaction

To examine Research Question 2, a multiple regression analysis was conducted to identify which workplace and professional factors significantly predict teachers' overall job satisfaction. Multiple regression is an appropriate statistical technique when the aim is to analyse the relationship between one continuous dependent variable and several independent variables simultaneously (Field, 2018). This method allows the researcher to assess the relative contribution of each predictor while controlling for the influence of other variables included in the model. To address the comparative dimension of Research Question 2, mean scores across all workplace factors are additionally compared between English Medium and National Curriculum teachers in Table 5.4b, following the regression results.

In this analysis, overall job satisfaction (JS_mean) was treated as the dependent variable. Based on the reliability analysis presented in Chapter 4, the variable System and societal factors was excluded from the regression model due to low internal consistency ($\alpha = -0.441$). In addition, Intention to leave was not included as a predictor in this model, as it is conceptualised as an outcome of job satisfaction rather than a determinant, consistent with the theoretical perspectives of Dinham and Scott (1998) and Skaalvik and Skaalvik (2011). The independent variables included leadership support, working conditions and resources, pay and benefits, autonomy, recognition and respect, collegial relationships, workload and stress, and intrinsic satisfaction derived from the work itself.

The standard assumptions for multiple regression were checked before the analysis was run — linearity between variables, independence of residuals, homoscedasticity, normal distribution of residuals, and no problematic multicollinearity among predictors. Nothing in the diagnostics gave reason for concern, so the results can be taken as reliable.

Table 5.4. Multiple regression analysis: Predictors of overall job satisfaction

Predictor	*B*	*SE*	*β*	*t*	*p*
Pay and benefits	**0.215**	**0.039**	**.264****	**5.458**	**< .001**
Work itself	**0.304**	**0.063**	**.245****	**4.857**	**< .001**
Leadership support	**0.198**	**0.054**	**.195****	**3.658**	**< .001**
Collegial relationships	**0.122**	**0.054**	**.111***	**2.248**	**.025**
Recognition and respect	0.107	0.058	.103	1.830	.068
Working conditions and resources	0.072	0.045	.063	1.579	.116

Autonomy	0.032	0.055	.030	0.577	.565
Workload and stress	0.046	0.049	.046	0.951	.342
Model: $R^2 = .625$, Adjusted $R^2 = .615$, $F(8, 291) = 60.75$, $p < .001$					

Note. B = unstandardised coefficient; SE = standard error; β = standardised beta coefficient.
** p < .05 ** p < .001. Non-significant predictors shown for completeness.*

The regression model was statistically significant, $F(8, 291) = 60.75$, $p < .001$, indicating that the set of predictor variables collectively explained a substantial proportion of the variation in teachers' job satisfaction. The model explained 62.5% of the variance in job satisfaction ($R^2 = .625$, Adjusted $R^2 = .615$). The strength of this explanatory power indicates that workplace and professional conditions are the primary drivers of how teachers evaluate their professional lives — a finding that positions institutional factors, rather than individual characteristics, as the central determinants of satisfaction in this context.

Four statistically significant predictors of job satisfaction were identified. Pay and benefits was the strongest predictor ($\beta = .264$, $p < .001$). The strength of this association reflects the structural financial conditions facing teachers in Bangladesh — with 40% of the sample earning less than 25,000 BDT per month and pay recording the lowest mean score of all workplace factors ($M = 2.87$), financial dissatisfaction is not a peripheral concern but a pervasive feature of the professional landscape. Where financial conditions are as strained as they are in this sample, pay ceases to be one factor among many and becomes the dominant constraint on overall professional wellbeing.

Intrinsic satisfaction from the work itself was the second strongest predictor ($\beta = .245$, $p < .001$). This points to a professional dynamic in which the act of teaching itself — student engagement, learning relationships, pedagogical fulfilment — sustains satisfaction independently of the institutional conditions surrounding it. The high mean score for this variable ($M = 3.94$, the highest of all workplace factors) alongside the lowest mean for pay creates a distinctive profile: teachers in this sample find deep meaning in their work while being structurally undermined by their financial conditions — a coexistence that Herzberg's two-factor theory would predict and that the regression confirms empirically.

Leadership support was the third significant predictor ($\beta = .195$, $p < .001$). This suggests that school-level leadership plays a central role in shaping teachers' professional experience, reinforcing the importance of organisational climate over purely structural factors. The finding indicates that how teachers are managed — whether they feel heard, supported, and trusted by their principals — independently shapes their overall satisfaction even after controlling for pay, working conditions, and intrinsic rewards simultaneously.

Collegial relationships were the fourth significant predictor ($\beta = .111$, $p = .025$). Even when controlling for pay, leadership, and intrinsic satisfaction simultaneously, peer relationships retain independent predictive power. This indicates that the social environment of the school shapes professional wellbeing in ways that institutional conditions alone cannot explain — that teachers who

work alongside cooperative and mutually supportive colleagues are measurably more satisfied, regardless of what else their working environment provides or withholds.

Other variables — working conditions and resources, autonomy, recognition and respect, and workload and stress — did not reach statistical significance when considered alongside the four significant predictors. Recognition and respect came closest (β = .103, p = .068), a marginal result suggesting it may play a genuine role that the present model's specification does not fully capture. The non-significance of these variables is better understood as reflecting shared variance with the stronger predictors than as evidence of irrelevance — a possibility discussed in Section 6.2.5.

What the data reveal, taken together, is a picture in which both financial conditions and the intrinsic rewards of teaching are the dominant forces shaping satisfaction — with school-level leadership and collegial relationships providing meaningful additional explanatory power. Pay and benefits, intrinsic satisfaction from the work itself, leadership support, and collegial relationships together represent the four conditions most directly implicated in how teachers in urban Bangladesh experience and evaluate their professional lives.

Table 5.4b. Mean scores by school type across all workplace factors

Variable	***English Medium M (SD)***	***National Curriculum M (SD)***	***Difference***
Overall job satisfaction	3.77 (0.70)	3.25 (0.95)	0.52*
Work itself	4.10 (0.65)	3.77 (0.73)	0.33
Collegial relationships	3.91 (0.74)	3.70 (0.84)	0.21
Recognition and respect	3.82 (0.79)	3.51 (0.89)	0.31
Autonomy	3.78 (0.77)	3.50 (0.86)	0.28
Working conditions and resources	3.74 (0.81)	3.39 (0.90)	0.35
Leadership support	3.58 (0.82)	3.14 (0.89)	0.44
Workload and stress	3.22 (0.74)	3.07 (0.78)	0.15
System and societal factors	3.05 (0.61)	2.83 (0.64)	0.22
Intention to leave	3.05 (1.07)	3.50 (1.09)	−0.45
Pay and benefits	3.12 (1.03)	2.63 (1.09)	0.49

*Note. M = Mean; SD = Standard Deviation. * Statistically significant difference, t (298) = 5.351, p < .001, Cohen's d = 0.62.*
Differences for individual factors are descriptive; separate t-tests would be needed to confirm statistical significance.

To address the comparative dimension of Research Question 2, Table 5.4b presents mean scores across all workplace factors separately for English Medium and National Curriculum teachers. English Medium teachers scored higher on every workplace factor without exception. The largest gaps were observed in pay and benefits (EM: M = 3.12, NC: M = 2.63, difference = 0.49) and leadership support (EM: M = 3.58, NC: M = 3.14, difference = 0.44) — the two factors that also emerge as the strongest predictors in the regression model. The alignment between where the groups differ most and what predicts satisfaction most strongly is not coincidental: it suggests that the conditions most responsible for the satisfaction gap identified in Research Question 1 are precisely the same conditions that the

regression identifies as the primary drivers of satisfaction overall. English Medium teachers score higher on satisfaction in large part because they score higher on the factors that matter most.

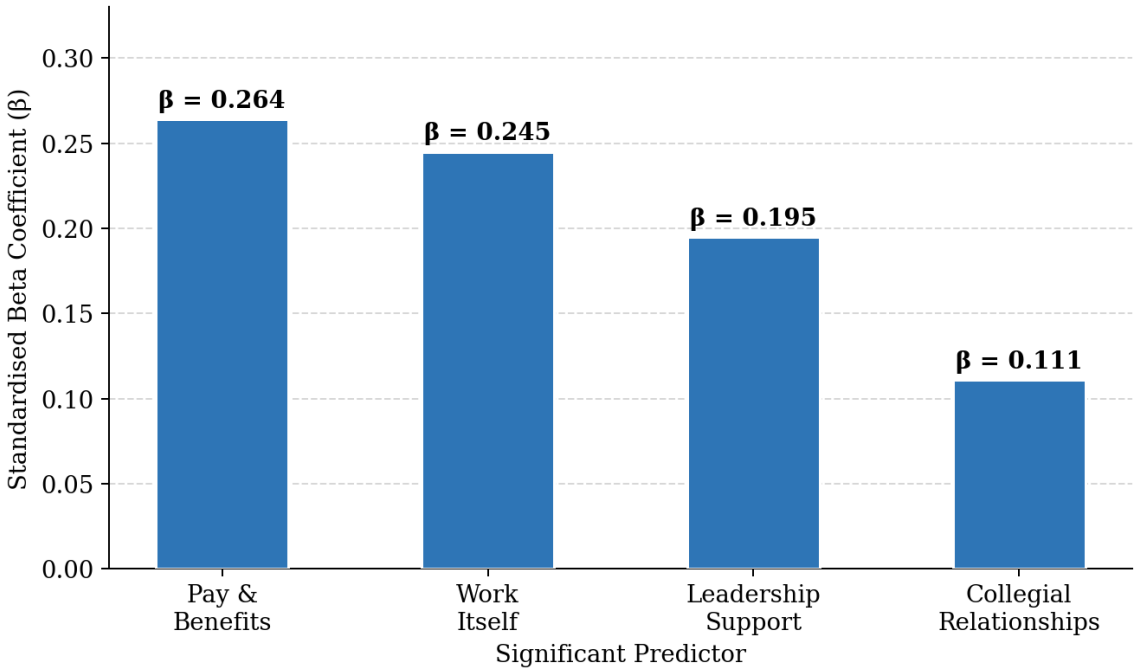


Figure 4. Significant predictors of job satisfaction

Figure 4 shows the relative strength of the statistically significant predictors of job satisfaction. The pattern is clear: financial conditions and intrinsic professional rewards account for the two strongest associations, with school-level leadership and collegial relationships providing meaningful additional explanatory power. Together, these four predictors represent both the institutional and the relational dimensions of teachers' professional lives — and the data indicate that both dimensions independently matter.

5.5 Teachers' Job Satisfaction and Intention to Stay or Leave Their Current School or Profession

To examine Research Question 3, multiple regression analysis was conducted to investigate the relationship between teacher job satisfaction and teachers' intention to remain in or leave their current school or the teaching profession. The analysis explored whether overall job satisfaction and selected workplace factors are associated with teachers' turnover intentions.

In this model, intention to leave (IL_mean) was treated as the dependent variable. Based on the reliability results presented in Chapter 4, the variable System and societal factors was excluded from the regression model due to low internal consistency ($\alpha = -0.441$). The independent variables included overall job satisfaction, leadership support, working conditions and resources, pay and benefits, autonomy, recognition and respect, collegial relationships, workload and stress, and intrinsic satisfaction from the work itself. Before running the regression, the standard assumptions of multiple

regression were checked — linearity, independence of errors, normality of residuals, homoscedasticity, and multicollinearity. The diagnostics indicated these assumptions were sufficiently met, giving reasonable confidence in the validity of the results.

Table 5.5. Multiple regression analysis: Predictors of intention to leave

Predictor	***B***	***SE***	***β***	***t***	***P***
Overall job satisfaction	**0.462**	**0.063**	**.371****	**7.303**	**< .001**
Pay and benefits	**0.275**	**0.050**	**.233****	**5.518**	**< .001**
Recognition and respect	**0.231**	**0.074**	**.184****	**3.129**	**.002**
Work itself	**0.163**	**0.074**	**.115***	**2.176**	**.030**
Leadership support	0.092	0.061	.063	1.508	.133
Collegial relationships	0.078	0.069	.049	1.134	.258
Autonomy	0.051	0.066	.034	0.776	.438
Workload and stress	0.044	0.070	.027	0.629	.530
Working conditions and resources	0.031	0.063	.021	0.494	.622
Model: $R^2 = .624$, Adjusted $R^2 = .611$, $F(10, 289) = 47.94$, $p < .001$					

Note. B = unstandardised coefficient; SE = standard error; β = standardised beta coefficient.
** p < .05 ** p < .001. Non-significant predictors shown for completeness.*

The regression model was statistically significant and accounted for a substantial share of the variance in teachers' intention to leave, $R^2 = .624$, Adjusted $R^2 = .611$, $p < .001$. Put plainly, around 62% of the variation in turnover intentions can be explained by the job satisfaction and workplace factors included in the model. That is a reasonably strong result, and it suggests that teachers' professional experiences are not loosely connected to whether they stay or go — the relationship is fairly direct and consistent across the sample.

Overall job satisfaction emerged as the strongest individual predictor ($\beta = .371$, $p < .001$). Teachers who reported higher levels of satisfaction were considerably less likely to express any intention to leave their school or the profession more broadly. This is not a surprising finding in isolation, but the strength of the association is worth noting — it reinforces the theoretical position that satisfaction sits at the centre of retention, not at its edges (Skaalvik & Skaalvik, 2011). Pay and benefits also showed a statistically significant relationship with intention to leave ($\beta = .233$, $p < .001$). Teachers who were less satisfied with their salary and financial conditions were more likely to be thinking about leaving. This finding is a reminder that however much teachers value the intrinsic side of their work, financial conditions continue to shape career decisions in meaningful ways — particularly in a context like Bangladesh where pay levels are often modest and inconsistent across school types.

Recognition and respect followed a similar pattern ($\beta = .184$, $p = .002$). Teachers who felt genuinely valued and respected within their professional environment were less likely to express intentions to

leave. This points to something beyond material conditions — how teachers are seen and treated within their institutions appears to influence how long they are willing to stay. It may be that recognition feeds into a broader sense of professional identity and belonging, making departure feel less necessary even when other conditions are imperfect. The work itself — the intrinsic satisfaction that comes from daily teaching activities — also showed a significant though comparatively modest relationship with intention to leave ($\beta = .115$, $p = .030$). Teachers who experienced their work as meaningful and rewarding tended to report lower turnover intentions, which adds further weight to the argument that intrinsic motivation is not just a nice feature of the job but a genuine factor in keeping teachers in it.

Several other variables — leadership support, autonomy, collegial relationships, workload and stress, and working conditions and resources — did not reach statistical significance in the model. This should be interpreted carefully. It does not mean these factors are unimportant in any general sense. In a multiple regression model where several predictors are entered simultaneously, variables that correlate with stronger predictors can lose their individual significance even when they carry real explanatory weight on their own. Their effects are likely absorbed by the stronger predictors rather than absent altogether.

On a descriptive level, National Curriculum teachers reported a noticeably higher mean intention to leave ($M = 3.50$, $SD = 1.09$) compared to English-medium teachers ($M = 3.05$, $SD = 1.07$). This gap sits in direct alignment with the satisfaction differences reported in Section 5.3 and with the regression finding that overall satisfaction is the dominant predictor of retention intentions. Teachers working within a system that consistently produces lower satisfaction are, not surprisingly, more likely to be weighing up whether to leave it — and the data here reflect that pattern clearly.

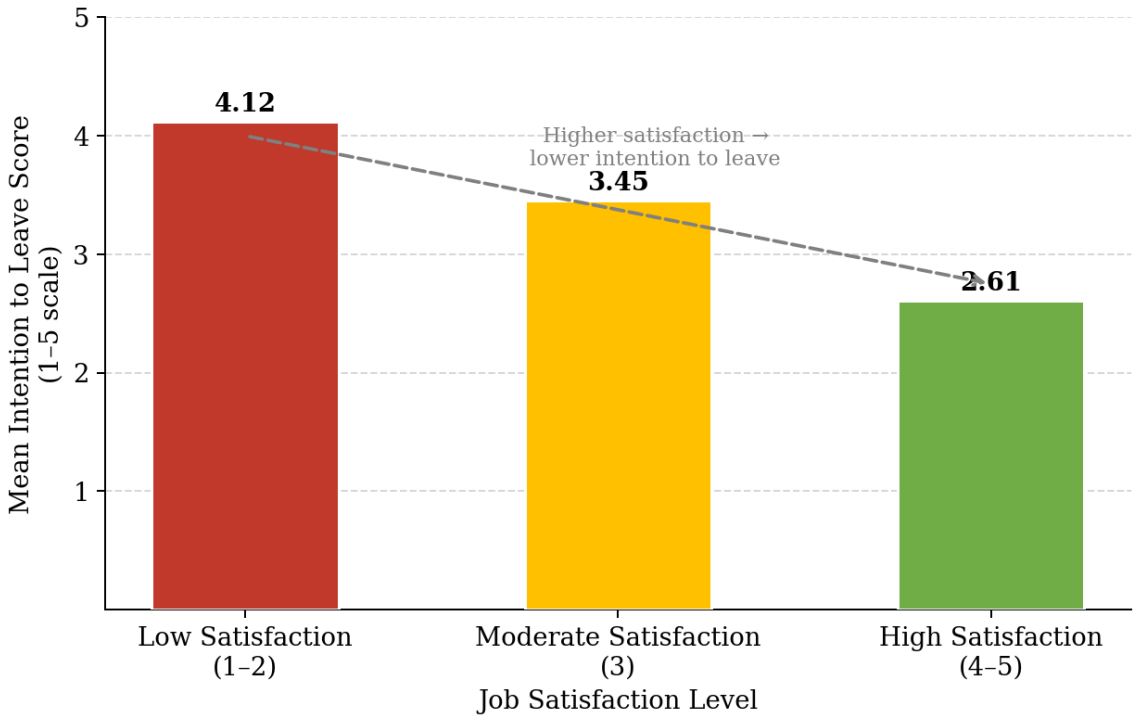


Figure 5. Relationship between job satisfaction and intention to leave

Figure 5 shows the relationship between job satisfaction and intention to leave, indicating that higher job satisfaction is associated with lower intention to leave the teaching profession. The figure visually supports the regression results showing a strong association between satisfaction and retention intentions.

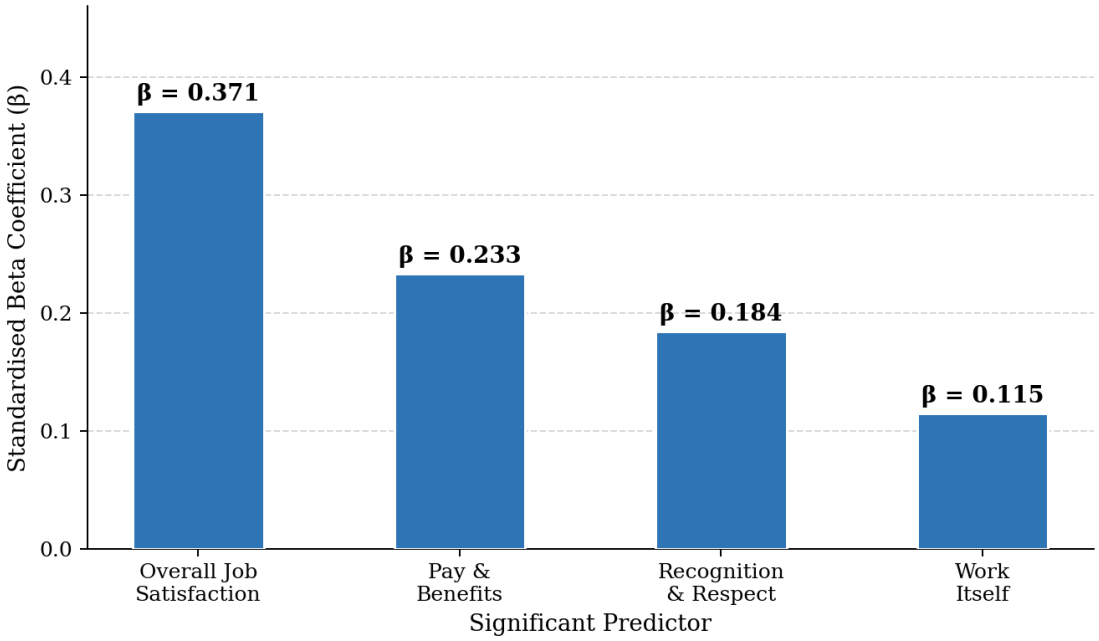


Figure 6. Significant predictors of intention to leave (standardised beta coefficients)

Note. All four predictors are statistically significant ($p < .05$). Higher β indicates stronger association with intention to leave.

Figure 6 shows the standardised beta coefficients for the significant predictors of intention to leave.

5.6 Summary of Findings

The findings of this study demonstrate a clear divergence in professional experiences between the two schooling systems in Bangladesh. Independent samples *t*-tests confirmed that English Medium teachers report significantly higher job satisfaction than their National Curriculum counterparts, a difference characterised by a moderate effect size. When examining the drivers of this satisfaction, pay and benefits, intrinsic satisfaction from work itself, leadership support, and collegial relationships were identified as the most important predictors of job satisfaction. Importantly, the study validated the directional relationship proposed in the conceptual framework: higher job satisfaction directly predicts a lower intention to leave the profession. These results suggest that to improve teacher retention and system sustainability, policy interventions must focus on ensuring adequate financial compensation and protecting the intrinsic rewards of teaching, alongside strengthening school-level leadership.

Table 5.6. Summary of research questions, methods, and key findings

Research Question	***Statistical Method***	***Key Finding***	***Outcome***
RQ1: Is there any difference in overall job satisfaction between English Medium and National Curriculum school teachers in Bangladesh?	Independent samples t-test	English Medium teachers (M = 3.77, SD = 0.70) reported significantly higher overall job satisfaction than National Curriculum teachers (M = 3.25, SD = 0.95). t(298) = 5.351, p < .001, Cohen's d = 0.62 (moderate effect).	Significant difference confirmed ✓
RQ2: Is there any difference in the factors related to teacher job satisfaction between English Medium and National Curriculum school teachers in Bangladesh?	Multiple regression (R^2 = .625, Adjusted R^2 = .615, F(8, 291) = 60.75, p < .001)	Four significant predictors identified: • Pay and benefits (β = .264, p < .001) — strongest predictor • Work itself / intrinsic satisfaction (β = .245, p < .001) • Leadership support (β = .195, p < .001) • Collegial relationships (β = .111, p = .025) Non-significant: working conditions, autonomy, recognition & respect, workload & stress. EM teachers scored higher than NC teachers on every workplace factor, with the largest gaps in pay and benefits and leadership support (Table 5.4b).	Significant predictors identified; EM teachers show more favourable conditions across all factors ✓
RQ3: Is there any difference in teacher job satisfaction related to teachers' intention to stay or leave their current school or profession between English Medium and National Curriculum school teachers in Bangladesh?	Multiple regression (R^2 = .624, Adjusted R^2 = .611, p < .001)	Higher satisfaction = lower intention to leave across both school groups. Analysis conducted on combined sample — NC teachers reported higher mean intention to leave (M = 3.50) than EM teachers (M = 3.05), consistent with their lower satisfaction levels.	Strong satisfaction-turnover relationship confirmed; pattern consistent across both school types ✓

Note. β = standardised beta coefficient. ✓ = statistically significant result at p < .05.

Chapter 6: Discussion

This chapter discusses the findings presented in Chapter 5 in relation to the three research questions guiding this study. The discussion interprets the statistical results within the context of existing empirical research reviewed in Chapter 2 and the theoretical frameworks outlined in Chapter 3. Each research question is addressed in turn, with findings compared to previous studies and explained through the lens of Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory, Dinham and Scott's Three-Domain Model, and Self-Determination Theory. The chapter then discusses the broader implications of the findings for teacher policy and school management in Bangladesh, before acknowledging the limitations of the study and identifying directions for future research.

6.1 Discussion of Research Question 1: Differences in Overall Job Satisfaction Between English Medium and National Curriculum Teachers

The first research question asked whether overall job satisfaction differs between English-medium and National Curriculum school teachers in Bangladesh. It does. English-medium teachers reported meaningfully higher satisfaction ($M = 3.77$) compared to their National Curriculum counterparts ($M = 3.25$) — a difference the t-test confirmed as statistically significant ($t(298) = 5.351$, $p < .001$) and the effect size placed in the moderate range (Cohen's $d = 0.62$). The gap is not a statistical footnote. It points to something structural — the institution a teacher works in, and the conditions that come with it, shapes how they experience their work in ways that matter.

This pattern is not unique to Bangladesh. Noori (2023) found similar differences between public and private school teachers, linking them to variations in employment conditions, job security, and institutional support (pp. 9–10). Hussain et al. (2022) found that public school teachers in Pakistan reported higher overall satisfaction than those in private schools (p. 4), attributing this to differences in resources, security, and working conditions. The present study finds something similar in structure, though the direction runs the other way — in Bangladesh, it is the private English-medium schools that appear to offer the more favourable conditions. Small and Buckman (2021) also documented satisfaction differences between publicly and privately managed schools, noting that privately managed institutions often provide greater resources and professional autonomy, which can translate into higher satisfaction even where job security is less guaranteed (pp. 65–66). Taken together, these studies suggest that sector-based variation in teacher satisfaction is a fairly consistent finding across different national contexts, even if the specific direction of the difference varies.

Theoretically, these findings sit comfortably within Dinham and Scott's (1998) Three-Domain Model. The model identifies school-level conditions — Domain 2 — as a primary driver of both satisfaction and dissatisfaction, arguing that the institutional environment directly shapes how teachers experience their professional lives (pp. 375–376). English-medium schools in Bangladesh operate as market-oriented institutions that respond to fee-paying parental demand, which tends to push investment toward physical resources, teacher remuneration, and institutional infrastructure (Mousumi & Kusakabe, 2017, pp. 685–687). These are precisely the kinds of school-level conditions that Dinham and Scott's framework would predict to support higher satisfaction. National Curriculum schools — especially those outside the MPO scheme faces a different reality. Resource constraints are tighter,

salary levels are lower, and management structures tend to be more hierarchical. According to the same framework, these conditions are more likely to generate dissatisfaction than satisfaction.

One further finding deserves attention. The National Curriculum group showed a noticeably wider spread of responses (SD = 0.95) compared to the English-medium group (SD = 0.70). This is theoretically significant because it suggests that National Curriculum teachers do not form a uniform group — some report relatively high satisfaction while others report considerably lower levels. That variability most likely reflects the diversity of conditions within the sector itself, which ranges from well-resourced urban schools to under-resourced rural institutions operating in very different environments. This is a useful reminder that comparing across school types is only part of the picture. Variation within the National Curriculum sector is substantial enough to warrant its own attention and treating these schools as a single homogeneous category risks flattening differences that matter.

6.2 Factors Related to Teacher Job Satisfaction (Research Question 2)

The multiple regression analysis pointed to four statistically significant predictors of overall job satisfaction across the combined sample: pay and benefits, intrinsic satisfaction from the work itself, leadership support, and collegial relationships. Together with the non-significant variables in the model, these predictors accounted for 62.5% of the variance in overall job satisfaction ($R^2 = .625$) — a substantial figure that suggests workplace and professional conditions are deeply implicated in how teachers evaluate their working lives. This broadly aligns with international evidence showing that school-level organisational conditions tend to be the primary drivers of satisfaction, with individual teacher characteristics playing a comparatively limited role (Eryilmaz et al., 2025b, p. 10).

It is worth flagging one point of tension before moving into the individual predictors. While the findings largely support the theoretical frameworks set out in Chapter 3, they do not fully confirm what self-determination theory would lead us to expect — specifically, that autonomy would feature among the stronger predictors of satisfaction. That it did not is worth taking seriously rather than passing over, and Section 6.2.5 returns to this directly, considering measurement limitations and contextual constraints as plausible explanations for the gap. Each significant predictor is discussed in turn below, situated within the existing literature and the theoretical frameworks this study draws on.

6.2.1 Pay and Benefits as the Strongest Predictor

40% of teachers in this sample earn less than 25,000 BDT per month. This single statistic — drawn from a qualified, predominantly mid-career, predominantly permanent workforce in two of Bangladesh's largest cities — frames what the regression analysis confirms: pay and benefits is the strongest predictor of overall job satisfaction ($\beta = .264$, $p < .001$). That financial conditions dominate the satisfaction picture is not surprising given the structural economic realities of teaching in Bangladesh. Bennell and Akyeampong (2007) documented that teachers in most low-income countries studied, including Bangladesh, earn poverty-level wages of between $2 and $4 per day, with inadequate pay forcing many into secondary employment that divides their professional commitment (pp. 33, 54). In the present sample, pay and benefits recorded the lowest mean score of all workplace factors (M = 2.87) — nearly a full point below the scale midpoint — while work itself simultaneously recorded the highest (M = 3.94). Teachers in this study find deep meaning in their work. They are simply not being paid adequately for it.

This configuration is precisely what Herzberg's two-factor theory would predict. Salary operates as a hygiene factor — one whose inadequacy generates active dissatisfaction regardless of how rewarding the work itself may be (Herzberg et al., 1959, as cited in Dinham & Scott, 1998, p. 363). The paradox Dinham and Scott (1998) identified — whereby teachers continue to find meaning in teaching while expressing dissatisfaction with institutional conditions — is not merely confirmed here; it is shown to operate at a scale where financial dissatisfaction is severe enough to become the single strongest driver of overall satisfaction in the regression model, arguably overriding some of the protective effects of intrinsic motivation (pp. 375–376). This is Herzberg's hygiene factor mechanism in operation, not as abstract theory but as measurable institutional reality.

Comparative evidence from neighbouring South Asian contexts reinforces this pattern. Hussain et al. (2022) found that public school teachers in Pakistan reported significantly higher satisfaction than private school counterparts (p. 4), while Noori (2023) identified salary and employment security as differentiating factors between public and private school teachers in Afghanistan (pp. 9–10). Across these contexts, the relationship between financial conditions and satisfaction reflects not merely absolute income levels but the perceived fairness, stability, and professional respect that salary structures communicate. The implication for Research Question 1 is direct: English Medium schools generally offer higher and more reliable salary packages than National Curriculum schools, particularly non-government NC institutions that may fall outside formal salary support mechanisms. The pay gap between sectors is likely a central mechanism through which the overall satisfaction gap — $t(298) = 5.351$, $p < .001$ — is sustained.

6.2.2 Intrinsic Satisfaction from Work Itself

Teaching, at its best, is intrinsically rewarding. This is not a sentimental observation — it is a proposition embedded in all three theoretical frameworks guiding this study. Herzberg's two-factor theory identifies the nature of the work itself as a primary motivator factor whose presence generates satisfaction independently of extrinsic conditions (Herzberg et al., 1959, as cited in Dinham & Scott, 1998, p. 363). Dinham and Scott (1998) position Domain 1 — the intrinsic rewards of teaching — as typically the most stable and enduring source of professional satisfaction, closely tied to identity and resistant to erosion by institutional conditions (p. 363). Ryan and Deci (2000) propose that when individuals feel competent and experience their behaviour as self-determined, intrinsic motivation is sustained and more autonomous forms of extrinsic motivation are facilitated, producing greater engagement and wellbeing (pp. 58–60, 63). The present findings confirm all three propositions empirically. Intrinsic satisfaction from the work itself was the second strongest predictor of overall job satisfaction ($\beta = .245$, $p < .001$), remaining a significant independent predictor even after controlling for pay, leadership, working conditions, and six other workplace factors simultaneously.

The international evidence supports this pattern consistently. Wartenberg et al.'s (2023) meta-analysis documented a positive relationship between job satisfaction and student motivation ($r = .29$) and student achievement ($r = .10$) — a reciprocal dynamic in which meaningful teaching sustains satisfaction, and satisfaction in turn creates better conditions for learning (pp. 16–17). Klassen and Chiu (2010) found that self-efficacy for classroom management and instruction was positively associated with job satisfaction, while classroom stress arising from student misbehaviour directly reduced self-efficacy and indirectly lowered satisfaction (pp. 741, 747–748). In Dhaka specifically, Masoom (2021) identified workgroup encouragement and positive relationships with students as among the most critical conducive factors in teachers' professional environments (pp. 1, 5).

The finding carries a particular significance when read alongside the pay result. Teachers in this sample score lowest on pay (M = 2.87) and highest on work itself (M = 3.94) — the two variables that also happen to be the two strongest predictors of overall satisfaction. This suggests a professional landscape in which teachers are sustained primarily by what they find in the classroom while being structurally undermined by what they find on their payslip. Policies that erode the conditions enabling meaningful teaching — through excessive administrative demands, examination-driven curricula, or very large class sizes — risk dismantling the very resource that is currently absorbing the impact of financial dissatisfaction. For teachers whose pay satisfaction is low, the intrinsic rewards of teaching may be the primary reason they remain in the profession at all.

6.2.3 Leadership Support

Masoom (2021), studying teachers across primary and secondary schools in Dhaka, found that a positive relationship with the school principal was the single most important conducive factor in teachers' professional environments — more important than peer relationships, workload conditions, or resources (pp. 1, 5). The qualitative patterns he identified — principals who listen, who reduce unnecessary administrative demands, who create space for professional discretion — are precisely the leadership behaviours that self-determination theory associates with the satisfaction of the basic psychological need for autonomy (Ryan & Deci, 2000, pp. 58–60). The present regression results offer quantitative corroboration of that pattern on a substantially larger scale. Leadership support was the third significant predictor of overall job satisfaction ($\beta = .195$, $p < .001$), independently predicting satisfaction even after controlling simultaneously for pay, working conditions, and intrinsic factors.

The international evidence confirms that this is not a Bangladesh-specific dynamic. Bellibaş et al.'s (2025) meta-analysis of 39 studies involving 170,693 teachers found empowering leadership — characterised by distributing authority and fostering professional discretion — to be the most strongly associated leadership style with satisfaction ($r = .58$), followed by servant and transformational leadership (pp. 11, 13). Eryilmaz et al. (2025b) found leadership support positively associated with satisfaction in 27 of 46 Trends in International Mathematics and Science Study (TIMSS) 2019 countries, confirming that the leadership-satisfaction relationship operates across cultural and institutional contexts rather than being peculiar to high-income settings (p. 8). What the present study adds is its demonstration that this relationship holds within South Asia's dual-system context — in schools that range from market-oriented English Medium institutions to resource-constrained National Curriculum schools, leadership quality consistently shapes how teachers evaluate their professional lives.

Perhaps most relevant for the Bangladeshi context is Eryilmaz, Bellibaş and Berkovich's (2025a) finding that despite a significant overall decline in teacher job satisfaction across 31 countries between 2013 and 2018, the positive association between distributed leadership and satisfaction remained stable throughout the period (p. 8). Leadership, in other words, functions as a structural buffer — one of the few institutional factors that continues to protect teacher wellbeing even as broader systemic conditions deteriorate. This matters directly for National Curriculum schools, which often operate under hierarchical management structures that may limit teacher participation in institutional decision-making. Unlike salary reform, which requires government-level policy change, leadership development is a school-level intervention — making it a practical and accessible lever for improving satisfaction even where systemic constraints remain.

6.2.4 Collegial Relationships

The social fabric of the school matters. Collegial relationships was the fourth significant predictor of overall job satisfaction in the present study ($\beta = .111$, $p = .025$), and while its beta coefficient was the smallest among the significant predictors, the meaning of an independent significant relationship — sustained after controlling for pay, intrinsic satisfaction, leadership, and five other variables simultaneously — should not be underestimated. It tells us that how teachers relate to one another shapes how they evaluate their professional lives in ways that cannot be fully explained by any of the other workplace conditions measured in this study.

The international evidence on this is consistent. Admiraal (2025), drawing on data from 77,285 teachers across 24 European countries, found that participative, collaborative, and safe school climates were positively associated with teacher satisfaction across both Nordic and other European national contexts, with the relationships remaining largely similar regardless of national setting (pp. 488–490). Addimando (2019) found in the Swiss context that teachers in supportive work environments demonstrated stronger professional engagement and a more varied repertoire of teaching practices. These findings reflect self-determination theory's proposition that relatedness — the experience of genuine connection and belonging within one's social environment — is a basic psychological need whose satisfaction facilitates more autonomous forms of motivation and supports professional wellbeing (Ryan & Deci, 2000, pp. 54, 63–64).

Within Dinham and Scott's (1998) three-domain model, collegial relationships occupy a specifically important structural position as a Domain 2, school-level factor that can amplify or buffer the intrinsic satisfaction teachers derive from their work. When collegial relationships are positive, they sustain teachers' sense of professional identity, provide practical support, and create the conditions for collaborative professional growth. When they are poor, they compound the dissatisfaction generated by inadequate pay or unsupportive leadership, eroding whatever intrinsic motivation remains. This amplifying-or-buffering logic carries a specific implication for the National Curriculum sector. The wider variance in NC teachers' satisfaction scores ($SD = 0.95$ versus $SD = 0.70$) documented in Research Question 1 suggests that experiences within that sector are highly heterogeneous. Some of that heterogeneity is likely attributable to variation in the quality of collegial environments across NC schools — schools where professional community is actively cultivated will produce very different satisfaction profiles from those where teachers work in institutional isolation. Where salary reform and leadership development require systemic or organisational resources, building collegial culture is a dimension of professional life that school management can actively shape at relatively low cost.

6.2.5 Non-Significant Predictors

Working conditions and resources, autonomy, recognition and respect, and workload and stress did not reach statistical significance in the regression model when considered alongside the four significant predictors. The absence of significance for these variables should not be interpreted as evidence that they are irrelevant to teacher satisfaction — the empirical literature is clear that each plays a role in shaping professional wellbeing across diverse contexts. Rather, as is common in multiple regression analyses involving correlated predictors, the independent variance attributable to each of these factors may overlap substantially with that captured by the significant predictors, reducing the unique contribution of each to a level that falls below the threshold of statistical significance when the full model is estimated simultaneously (Field, 2018, p. 311).

Working conditions and resources is a case in point. This variable is consistently identified in the literature as a predictor of satisfaction in developing-country contexts, with Gamero Burón and Lassibille (2016) finding that poor school infrastructure, inadequate teaching materials, large class sizes, and multigrade teaching responsibilities were significant sources of dissatisfaction among primary school teachers in Madagascar (pp. 1638–1639), and Masoom (2021) identifying workload pressure and inadequate resources as primary toxic factors in Bangladeshi schools (pp. 5–6). Most teachers in this sample — regardless of school type — operate within similarly resource-constrained physical environments, meaning that working conditions may show less between-person variation than in higher-income settings. Where a predictor varies little across respondents, it has limited statistical capacity to explain variation in the outcome, even when its importance is well established theoretically.

Autonomy presents a related but distinct case. While SDT identifies autonomy as a basic psychological need whose satisfaction sustains intrinsic motivation and supports more autonomous forms of extrinsic motivation (Ryan & Deci, 2000, pp. 54, 58–60), the autonomy scale showed the weakest reliability in the pilot study ($\alpha = 0.478$) and, though it improved in the main sample ($\alpha = 0.735$), the scale comprised only two items. The limited depth of this measure may have attenuated the variable's predictive power, making it difficult to detect an effect even if one exists. Future studies with more comprehensive autonomy measures are likely to recover this relationship.

Recognition and respect came closest to significance of all the non-significant predictors ($\beta = .103$, $p = .068$), a marginal result that is worth noting. Mertler (2016) found that professional recognition ranked among the factors teachers most frequently associate with daily motivation, rated as motivating by 88% of the 9,053 teachers surveyed (pp. 40–41).and Dinham and Scott's (1998) three-domain model positions recognition as a school-level condition with meaningful bearing on satisfaction (pp. 375–376). The p-value of .068 suggests that recognition may play a genuine role that the present model is insufficiently powered to detect — a possibility that future research with larger samples or dedicated recognition measures should examine.

Workload and stress showed no significant relationship despite consistent evidence of a negative association with satisfaction across international research, including in Bangladeshi contexts (Eryilmaz et al., 2025b, p. 9; Rabbi, 2026, pp. 147–148). Two explanations are plausible. First, the effect of workload on satisfaction may be partially mediated through overall job satisfaction itself, reducing the apparent direct contribution of workload in a model that controls for other satisfaction-related variables. Second, the workload and stress scale's more modest internal consistency ($\alpha = .625$) may have introduced measurement error sufficient to attenuate the relationship. These non-significant results should therefore be read with care, and do not preclude the possibility that working conditions, autonomy, recognition, and workload shape satisfaction in ways that more sensitive future instruments may detect.

6.3 Discussion of Research Question 3: Job Satisfaction and Intention to Stay or Leave

The third research question asked whether there is a difference in the relationship between job satisfaction and teachers' intention to stay or leave between English Medium and National Curriculum teachers. To address this, multiple regression analysis was conducted on the combined sample, with intention to leave as the dependent variable. The model identified overall job satisfaction as the

strongest single predictor (β = .371, p < .001), alongside pay and benefits (β = .233, p < .001), recognition and respect (β = .184, p = .002), and intrinsic satisfaction from the work itself (β = .115, p = .030). Together, these variables and the non-significant predictors in the model explained 62.4% of the variance in turnover intentions (R^2 = .624, Adjusted R^2 = .611), confirming a strong and multifaceted relationship between professional experience and withdrawal cognitions.

It should be noted at the outset that the regression analysis was conducted on the combined sample rather than separately for each school type. The study was not designed to formally test whether the strength of the satisfaction-turnover relationship differs significantly between EM and NC teachers — a comparison that would require either separate group regressions or an interaction term, and that future research with group-specific samples of sufficient size could address more rigorously. What the present analysis does establish is the nature and strength of the factors shaping turnover intentions across both systems taken together, which is itself a meaningful contribution given the near-complete absence of prior evidence on this relationship in the Bangladeshi dual-school context.

The finding that overall job satisfaction is the strongest predictor of intention to leave echoes a large body of international evidence. Wartenberg et al.'s (2023, pp.16,17) meta-analysis documented a significant negative relationship between satisfaction and turnover intentions across 61 studies (r = −0.46), while Madigan and Kim (2021) found that satisfaction accounted for a meaningful proportion of variance in quitting intentions across samples totalling over 10,000 teachers (pp. 1, 9).Skaalvik and Skaalvik (2011) proposed that prolonged dissatisfaction triggers a progressive cycle of emotional exhaustion and reduced motivation that ultimately pushes teachers towards withdrawal (pp. 1030–1031, 1035–1036) — a process the present regression results support empirically. In the Bangladeshi context, Rabbi (2026) found that 28% of teachers in Khulna were planning to leave within the year, citing salary, burnout, and lack of professional growth as primary drivers (pp. 150,151). The present study extends those findings by identifying, with a larger and more diverse sample, the specific combination of factors that most powerfully predicts withdrawal cognitions. The present study's own descriptive data reinforce this pattern at the level of school type. National Curriculum teachers reported a higher mean intention to leave (M = 3.50) than English Medium teachers (M = 3.05), a difference of nearly half a scale point that, when read alongside the RQ1 finding of significantly lower NC satisfaction, suggests a coherent picture — lower satisfaction in the NC sector translates into stronger withdrawal cognitions. This descriptive pattern is consistent with the regression finding that satisfaction is the dominant predictor of turnover intentions, and implies that the structural conditions depressing NC teacher satisfaction are simultaneously driving the sector's higher attrition risk.

Pay and benefits exerted a particularly strong influence on intention to leave. Teachers who were financially dissatisfied were substantially more likely to report considering departure — a pattern that Mertler (2016) documented strikingly in a large-scale Arizona study, where salary ranked as the top reason teachers considered leaving despite placing only tenth as a daily source of motivation (pp. 41–42). The divergence between salary's role as a daily motivator and its role as a retention factor is consistent with Herzberg's two-factor theory, whereby extrinsic factors such as pay operate as hygiene factors whose inadequacy generates dissatisfaction without a corresponding capacity to generate active engagement when present (Dinham & Scott, 1998, p. 363). In Bangladesh, where 40% of the present sample earn less than 25,000 BDT monthly, this mechanism operates at scale — the financial conditions faced by a large proportion of teachers represent a structural pressure toward attrition that leadership improvements or professional development cannot substitute for.

Recognition and respect also emerged as a significant predictor of intention to leave. Teachers who felt valued and professionally respected within their school were less likely to report withdrawal intentions, a finding that reflects the importance of dignity and professional identity in career persistence decisions. Self-determination theory proposes that the satisfaction of both competence and relatedness needs facilitates more autonomous forms of motivation and greater engagement (Ryan & Deci, 2000, pp. 58–60, 63–64). Applied to the teaching profession, this suggests that when teachers feel effective in their role and connected to their colleagues and school community, sustained professional engagement is more likely. Dinham and Scott (1998) similarly observe that institutional and societal recognition of teaching as a valued profession functions as a system-level factor with real bearing on retention (pp. 375–376). In Bangladesh, where teaching has historically occupied a position of modest social prestige relative to other graduate professions, strengthening formal recognition mechanisms — through performance acknowledgement, career progression structures, and public affirmation of the profession's value — could meaningfully reduce withdrawal intentions without requiring the scale of investment that salary reform demands.

Intrinsic satisfaction from the work itself rounded out the significant predictors of intention to leave. Teachers who experienced their daily teaching as meaningful and rewarding were less inclined to consider departure — a finding consistent with Ryan and Deci's (2000) theoretical argument that intrinsically motivated engagement is sustained by the work itself rather than contingent on external rewards, making it a more durable source of professional commitment (pp. 55-58,63). Dinham and Scott (1998) developed this idea specifically for the teaching context, arguing that the satisfaction derived from student relationships and learning outcomes serves as a protective factor against attrition even under difficult institutional conditions (pp. 375–376). The implication is direct: policies and management practices that reduce meaningful teaching time — through heavy administrative loads, standardised examination pressures, or excessive class sizes — not only erode satisfaction but also accelerate the withdrawal decisions of teachers who might otherwise remain.

Leadership support, autonomy, collegial relationships, working conditions and resources, and workload and stress did not reach significance in this model. As with the RQ2 regression, this likely reflects shared variance with the significant predictors rather than true absence of effect. The finding that collegial relationships and leadership — both significant in the satisfaction model — were not independently significant in the turnover model suggests that their influence on retention operates largely through overall satisfaction, which itself is the dominant predictor of intention to leave.

6.4 Implications of the Findings

The findings carry practical weight for how teacher policy and school management in Bangladesh are approached. The satisfaction gap between English-medium and National Curriculum teachers is not a minor statistical difference — it points to structural inequalities in the conditions of teaching that run across two parallel systems serving very different populations. National Curriculum teachers averaged 3.25 against 3.77 for their English-medium counterparts, and the wider spread of scores within the National Curriculum sector tells its own story: conditions are not just lower on average, they are deeply uneven — some teachers are working in professional environments that are markedly worse than others within the same system. Addressing this will require more than marginal adjustments. Salary payments need regularising, school leadership needs investment through targeted training, and the physical conditions of National Curriculum classrooms need serious attention. These are not peripheral concerns. If they go unaddressed, the satisfaction gap between the two systems is likely to grow — English-medium schools are expanding, and they are pulling more qualified teachers toward

them through better pay and working conditions (Mousumi & Kusakabe, 2017, pp. 679, 683). A National Curriculum sector that cannot compete on those terms risks being left further behind.

Alongside this, the finding that pay and benefits was the strongest predictor of overall job satisfaction ($\beta = .264$, $p < .001$) — and also a significant driver of intention to leave — confirms that salary remains the most structurally urgent challenge in Bangladesh's teaching profession. With 40% of the present sample earning less than 25,000 BDT per month and pay recording the lowest mean score of all workplace factors, financial conditions represent a foundational barrier to satisfaction that school-level management alone cannot address. This aligns with Bennell and Akyeampong's (2007) finding that teachers in low-income countries, including Bangladesh, earn poverty-level wages that generate persistent financial insecurity and force many into secondary employment that divides their professional commitment (pp. 33, 54). As Herzberg's two-factor theory predicts, inadequate salary functions as a hygiene factor whose deficiency generates active dissatisfaction even when intrinsic rewards remain present (Herzberg et al., 1959, as cited in Dinham & Scott, 1998, p. 363). The Bangladesh government and relevant regulatory bodies should review salary structures for both school types, with particular attention to teachers in non-government and non-MPO schools who may fall entirely outside existing salary support mechanisms.

Furthermore, the finding that intrinsic satisfaction from the work itself was the second strongest predictor of job satisfaction ($\beta = .245$, $p < .001$) suggests that educational policy must protect the conditions that enable teachers to experience meaningful professional engagement. Teachers already find strong intrinsic rewards in their role — work itself recorded the highest mean score of all workplace factors — and this is one of the most important resources sustaining their commitment. Management practices that erode these intrinsic rewards, through excessive administrative demands, over-reliance on examination-driven pedagogy, or very large class sizes, risk undermining what the present findings identify as a primary driver of both satisfaction and retention. Dinham and Scott (1998) argue that intrinsic factors related to teaching itself are the most stable and enduring source of professional satisfaction (p. 363), and Ryan and Deci (2000) propose that autonomous motivation — where individuals engage in activities out of genuine interest or deeply held personal values rather than external pressure — is associated with greater persistence and engagement (pp. 58–60, 63). Policies that reduce unnecessary administrative burden and support student-centred practice may therefore be as important for retention as improvements to extrinsic conditions.

The finding that leadership support was the third significant predictor of job satisfaction ($\beta = .195$, $p < .001$) highlights the important role of school principals in shaping teachers' professional experiences. Teachers who perceived their leadership as supportive and collaborative reported substantially higher satisfaction — a pattern consistent with Bellibaş et al.'s (2025) meta-analytic finding that empowering leadership styles are the most strongly associated with teacher satisfaction (pp. 11, 13), and with Masoom's (2021) Dhaka-based finding that a positive relationship with the school principal was the most critical conducive factor in teachers' work environment (pp. 1, 5). Schools should invest in leadership development programmes that equip principals with the skills to provide participative, responsive management — particularly in the National Curriculum sector, where hierarchical structures may currently limit teachers' professional discretion. Eryilmaz, Bellibaş and Berkovich (2025a) demonstrate that, despite a significant overall decline in teacher job satisfaction across 31 countries between 2013 and 2018, the positive association between distributed leadership and satisfaction with the work environment remained stable across the period, suggesting that leadership continues to play a crucial role in supporting teacher satisfaction even in contexts of broader systemic decline (p. 8).

Finally, the finding that collegial relationships was a significant predictor of job satisfaction (β = .111, p = .025) suggests that building professional community within schools deserves deliberate policy attention, particularly in larger National Curriculum institutions where teachers may have fewer structured opportunities for interaction with colleagues. Positive peer relationships among teachers may contribute to the satisfaction of the basic psychological need for relatedness identified within self-determination theory, which proposes that feeling genuinely connected to others in one's social environment facilitates more autonomous forms of motivation (Ryan & Deci, 2000, pp. 54, 63–64), and Dinham and Scott (1998) identify collegial relationships as a school-level factor capable of amplifying or buffering the intrinsic satisfaction teachers derive from their work (pp. 375–376). School management can support this through structured opportunities for professional collaboration — shared planning time, peer observation, and professional learning communities — at relatively low institutional cost.

Taken together, these implications point to a multi-level policy response. Salary reform at the system level, leadership development at the school level, and curriculum policies that protect the intrinsic rewards of teaching represent the three most evidence-supported levers for improving teacher satisfaction and reducing turnover in both school systems. The present findings confirm that professional wellbeing is shaped primarily by institutional conditions rather than individual characteristics and therefore that it is meaningfully amenable to policy intervention.

6.5 Limitations of the Study

This study has several limitations that should be considered when interpreting the findings. The most immediate methodological concern relates to sampling. The study employed a non-probability sampling strategy combining purposive and snowball sampling. While this approach was appropriate given the limited access to formal school sampling frames in Bangladesh, it means that the sample cannot be considered fully representative of all English Medium and National Curriculum teachers in urban Bangladesh. The findings should therefore be treated as indicative of patterns within the studied group rather than as definitive conclusions about the broader teaching population. In particular, teachers who were less digitally connected or who had weaker professional networks may have been systematically underrepresented, potentially skewing the sample towards more engaged and better-resourced teachers.

A related concern involves the data collection method. Data were collected through a self-administered online questionnaire, which introduces the risk of self-report bias. Responses may have been shaped by social desirability — for instance, teachers reporting higher satisfaction than they actually experience, or understating their intention to leave for fear of professional consequences — as well as by idiosyncratic circumstances at the time of completion, such as a recent conflict with a colleague or a salary delay. These effects cannot be controlled for within a survey-only design. Future studies could address this by combining survey data with qualitative interviews, diary methods, or administrative records, which would provide a richer and more cross-validated picture of teachers' professional experiences.

Beyond these data concerns, the cross-sectional design imposes an important analytical boundary. The study captures a single point-in-time snapshot of job satisfaction and related variables. It does not permit conclusions about how satisfaction changes across a career, how it responds to specific policy interventions, or whether the relationships identified in this study are stable over time or specific to the period of data collection. Longitudinal designs — tracking the same teachers over multiple

measurement points — would provide stronger evidence about the direction and durability of the relationships identified here.

Of particular note is the exclusion of the System and Societal Factors scale from all regression analyses. The negative internal consistency coefficient ($\alpha = -0.441$) indicated a fundamental measurement problem rather than merely low reliability, most likely resulting from the contradictory directionality of the two items within the scale. As a result, the influence of broader systemic factors — including public perceptions of the teaching profession, policy instability, and accountability pressures — could not be statistically examined. This is a meaningful gap, since Dinham and Scott's (1998) three-domain model identifies system-level conditions as a distinct and important source of teacher dissatisfaction (pp. 375–376). Future research should invest in developing a validated, multi-item measure of system and societal factors tailored to the Bangladeshi context.

A further measurement concern applies to the autonomy scale. While it showed acceptable reliability in the main sample ($\alpha = 0.735$), comprised only two items and showed notably lower reliability in the pilot study ($\alpha = 0.478$). Given that autonomy is a theoretically central variable in both self-determination theory and Dinham and Scott's framework, the non-significant result for this predictor in the regression should be interpreted with caution. The brevity of the scale may have limited its capacity to capture the full range of professional discretion teachers experience, and a more comprehensive autonomy measure in future studies may recover a significant relationship.

The study focused exclusively on urban teachers in Dhaka and Chattogram. Rural teachers — who constitute a substantial portion of Bangladesh's total teaching workforce and who face markedly different working conditions, salary structures, and resource environments are not represented in the present sample. The generalisability of these findings to rural or semi-urban contexts is therefore uncertain, and a nationally representative study including rural teachers would provide a substantially more complete picture of teacher satisfaction across the country.

6.6 Suggestions for Future Research

Several directions for future research follow from the limitations identified above and the patterns the findings have raised. Longitudinal and mixed-methods designs would add considerably to what this study can offer. A cross-sectional design captures satisfaction at a single point in time, but how satisfaction shifts in response to policy changes or evolving institutional conditions is a different and equally important question. Qualitative work with English-medium and National Curriculum teachers could go further still — giving teachers space to articulate how they actually experience and make sense of the institutional differences between the two systems, rather than simply registering those differences through scaled responses.

Geographically, future research should move beyond urban settings. The present study was conducted in urban Bangladesh, but working conditions, salary levels, and access to professional development can look very different in rural and semi-urban areas. Broadening the geographical scope would not only strengthen the generalisability of findings but also provide a more honest basis for national policy recommendations — ones that do not inadvertently speak only to a fraction of the teaching workforce.

There is also room to look more closely at how teacher gender, experience, and qualification level interact with workplace conditions in shaping satisfaction. These variables appeared in the present study as background factors rather than as predictors or moderators, which left a set of theoretically interesting questions unaddressed. International evidence suggests gender differences in satisfaction are worth taking seriously (Eryilmaz et al., 2025b, pp. 9–11; Klassen & Chiu, 2010, pp. 741–748), and examining whether workplace factors predict satisfaction differently for male and female teachers in the Bangladeshi context would carry both theoretical and practical value.

Finally, future research should develop and validate a Bangladesh-specific teacher job satisfaction instrument that captures the unique institutional, cultural, and systemic dimensions of teaching in this context. The adapted TJSQ used in this study provided a useful and reliable foundation, but a purpose-built instrument that includes validated items on system-level pressures, societal recognition, and the specific conditions of both English Medium and National Curriculum schools would allow more precise and contextually grounded measurement of teacher satisfaction in future studies.

6.7 Summary

This chapter has discussed the findings of the study in relation to the three research questions, the existing empirical literature, and the theoretical frameworks adopted.

The discussion of Research Question 1 confirmed that English Medium teachers report significantly higher overall job satisfaction than National Curriculum teachers, a difference interpreted through Dinham and Scott's (1998) three-domain model as reflecting the more favourable school-level institutional conditions in the English Medium sector. The greater variability in satisfaction among National Curriculum teachers was noted as evidence of the heterogeneous and often precarious conditions within that sector.

The discussion of Research Question 2 identified pay and benefits, intrinsic satisfaction from the work itself, leadership support, and collegial relationships as the four significant predictors of overall job satisfaction. Pay emerged as the strongest predictor and was explained through Herzberg's two-factor theory, which classifies inadequate salary as a hygiene factor that generates active dissatisfaction regardless of intrinsic rewards. The contribution of intrinsic satisfaction and collegial relationships was situated within self-determination theory and Dinham and Scott's domain framework, both of which identify meaningful teaching activity and positive peer relationships as enduring sources of professional commitment.

The discussion of Research Question 3 confirmed that overall job satisfaction is the strongest predictor of intention to leave, with pay and recognition also emerging as significant drivers of turnover intentions — findings consistent with the international meta-analytic evidence and directly relevant to the retention challenges facing the Bangladeshi teaching profession.

The chapter concluded by identifying salary reform, leadership development, and the protection of intrinsic teaching rewards as the three most evidence-supported policy levers, before acknowledging the study's key limitations and directions for future research. The following chapter presents the overall conclusions of the study.

Chapter 7: Conclusion

This chapter presents the overall conclusions of the study. It summarises the main findings in relation to the three research questions, reflects on the contribution of the study to existing knowledge, and highlights the key messages for educational policy and practice in Bangladesh. The chapter ends with brief final reflections on the significance of the study.

7.1 Overview of the Study

This study set out to examine teacher job satisfaction in two parallel school systems in urban Bangladesh — English Medium schools and National Curriculum schools. Despite the rapid growth of English Medium education in Bangladesh and the structural differences between the two school systems, no previous comparative study had examined whether teachers in these two systems experience different levels of job satisfaction, what factors predict their satisfaction, and how satisfaction relates to their intention to stay in or leave the profession. This study addressed these three gaps through a cross-sectional design using a quantitative strategy, collecting data from 300 teachers…collecting data from 300 teachers equally distributed across both school types in Dhaka and Chattogram.

The study was guided by three theoretical frameworks — Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory, Dinham and Scott's Three-Domain Model of Teacher Satisfaction, and Self-Determination Theory — which together provided a conceptual basis for understanding how intrinsic and extrinsic workplace factors shape teachers' professional experiences and retention decisions. Data were collected using an adapted version of the Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (TJSQ) and analysed using independent samples t-tests and multiple regression analysis in IBM SPSS Statistics.

7.2 Summary of Main Findings

The study produced three sets of main findings, each corresponding to one of the research questions.

Research Question 1: Difference in overall job satisfaction between school types

In response to the first research question, the study found that English Medium teachers reported significantly higher overall job satisfaction than National Curriculum teachers. The mean satisfaction score for English Medium teachers was 3.77 (SD = 0.70) compared to 3.25 (SD = 0.95) for National Curriculum teachers — a difference that was statistically significant, $t(298) = 5.351$, $p < .001$, and represented a moderate effect size (Cohen's $d = 0.62$). This finding confirms that the institutional context in which teachers work — shaped by differences in salary structures, resource availability, leadership practices, and governance arrangements — meaningfully influences their professional satisfaction. The greater variability in satisfaction scores among National Curriculum teachers also indicated that this group's professional experiences are considerably more diverse than those of their English Medium counterparts, reflecting the heterogeneous conditions that characterise the National Curriculum sector, particularly among non-government and non-MPO institutions.

Research Question 2: Predictors of overall job satisfaction

The multiple regression analysis identified four statistically significant predictors of overall job satisfaction across the combined sample: pay and benefits, intrinsic satisfaction from the work itself, leadership support, and collegial relationships. Together with the non-significant variables in the model, these factors explained 62.5% of the variance in overall job satisfaction ($R^2 = .625$, Adjusted $R^2 = .615$, $F(8, 291) = 60.752$, $p < .001$). Pay and benefits emerged as the single strongest predictor — a finding that reflects the structural financial conditions facing teachers in Bangladesh, where 40% of the sample reported earning less than 25,000 BDT per month and pay recorded the lowest mean score of all workplace factors ($M = 2.87$). The strong and independent contribution of intrinsic satisfaction from the work itself highlights that financial conditions alone do not determine professional wellbeing — teachers derive deep meaning from their daily teaching activities, and this sustains satisfaction even under difficult extrinsic conditions. Leadership support and collegial relationships confirmed the importance of the organisational and social environment of the school in shaping how teachers evaluate their professional lives. Working conditions, autonomy, recognition and respect, and workload and stress did not reach significance, a pattern best understood as reflecting shared variance with the stronger predictors rather than irrelevance.

On the comparative dimension of RQ2, the descriptive analysis in Table 5.4b revealed that English Medium teachers scored higher than National Curriculum teachers on every workplace factor without exception. The largest gaps were observed in pay and benefits and leadership support — the same two factors that emerged as the strongest regression predictors. This alignment suggests that the conditions most responsible for the satisfaction gap identified in RQ1 are precisely the conditions that matter most for satisfaction overall, connecting the two research questions into a coherent explanatory picture.

Research Question 3: Job satisfaction and intention to leave

In response to the third research question, the regression analysis confirmed that overall job satisfaction is a strong predictor of teachers' intention to leave the profession, with the full model explaining 62.4% of the total variance in turnover intentions ($R^2 = .624$, Adjusted $R^2 = .611$). The finding demonstrates that teachers' decisions about whether to remain in or leave the profession are shaped by a combination of workplace factors, with overall job satisfaction operating as a central mediating influence between working conditions and retention decisions.

The three sets of findings, taken together, present a coherent picture of teacher professional experience in urban Bangladesh. English Medium teachers benefit from salary structures, governance arrangements, and working environments that generate higher satisfaction — and this satisfaction, in turn, reduces their withdrawal intentions. National Curriculum teachers, by contrast, face greater financial pressure, more variable institutional conditions, and lower average satisfaction — conditions that, taken together, increase the likelihood of turnover cognitions. The findings indicate that improving teacher retention in the National Curriculum sector will require addressing both the financial and relational dimensions of teachers' working lives simultaneously.

The findings should be interpreted in light of several methodological limitations. The use of non-probability sampling and a cross-sectional design means that causal conclusions cannot be drawn and that the results may not be fully generalisable to the broader teacher population in Bangladesh. The study also focused exclusively on urban teachers in Dhaka and Chattogram, and the System and Societal Factors scale was excluded from regression analyses due to measurement issues. These

limitations are discussed in detail in Chapter 6 and inform the directions for future research presented in that chapter.

7.3 Contribution of the Study

This study makes several contributions to the existing body of knowledge on teacher job satisfaction. Most immediately, it fills a gap that is both empirically significant and practically consequential. No previous comparative quantitative study has examined job satisfaction between English Medium and National Curriculum school teachers in Bangladesh using a common measurement framework. By filling this gap, the study provides original empirical evidence about a dimension of Bangladesh's educational landscape that has been largely invisible in the academic literature — evidence that is directly relevant to teacher policy, workforce planning, and school management in both sectors.

Building on this empirical contribution, the study demonstrates that well-established theoretical frameworks developed in Western and high-income country contexts retain genuine analytical value when applied to the Bangladeshi setting. The patterns identified in the data are broadly consistent with the predictions of Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory, Dinham and Scott's Three-Domain Model, and Self-Determination Theory, and with findings from previous research in low- and middle-income countries. This suggests that the core mechanisms linking workplace conditions to satisfaction and retention are broadly consistent across diverse educational systems — though the present study alone cannot establish their generalisability beyond the urban Bangladeshi context.

At the level of measurement, the study contributes methodologically by adapting the Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire for use in the specific context of Bangladesh's dual school system and demonstrating acceptable reliability across most scales. The adapted instrument provides a foundation that future researchers can build on and refine, particularly in developing a more comprehensive measure of the system and societal factors dimension that could not be retained in the present study's regression analyses.

Perhaps most distinctively from a disciplinary perspective, the study contributes to the field of Comparative and International Education by examining how parallel school systems within the same national context produce different patterns of teacher professional experience. This within-country comparative perspective complements the dominant cross-national comparison approach in the international literature and demonstrates the value of examining institutional variation at the sub-national level — a level of analysis that is often overlooked but that can reveal inequalities in professional experience that national-level data obscure — and in doing so, positions this study as a meaningful starting point for a line of comparative research on teacher wellbeing in Bangladesh that has, until now, been almost entirely absent from the literature.

7.4 Implications for Policy and Practice

The findings carry direct implications for educational policy and school management in Bangladesh. The most urgent implication concerns salary. The finding that pay and benefits is both a significant predictor of job satisfaction and a driver of intention to leave — combined with the fact that 40% of teachers in the sample earn less than 25,000 BDT per month — indicates that financial conditions represent a critical barrier to teacher satisfaction and retention that cannot be addressed through

school-level management alone. Government policy should prioritise a review of salary structures for teachers in both English Medium and National Curriculum schools, with particular attention to the conditions of teachers in non-government, non-MPO schools who receive limited state financial support.

School leadership development is a second priority. Although pay and benefits emerged as the strongest predictor of overall satisfaction, and intrinsic rewards from the work itself as the second, leadership support was nonetheless the third significant workplace predictor ($\beta = .195$, $p < .001$) — and the one most directly amenable to school-level intervention without requiring system-wide policy change. The quality of school management has a direct and significant impact on teachers' daily professional experiences, and empowering school leaders to adopt more participative and supportive management styles could meaningfully improve satisfaction, particularly in National Curriculum schools where hierarchical structures may currently limit teachers' professional discretion. Investing in structured leadership development programmes — focusing on collaborative decision-making, professional recognition practices, and responsive communication — could improve teacher satisfaction at relatively low cost compared to systemic salary reform, making it a practical near-term lever even in resource-constrained settings.

Protecting the intrinsic rewards of teaching is a third important implication. The consistent finding that intrinsic satisfaction from the work itself predicts both job satisfaction and retention decisions suggests that policies which reduce meaningful teaching time — through excessive administrative demands, examination-focused curricula, or large class sizes — risk eroding one of the most powerful sources of teacher commitment. Curriculum and management policies should create space for teachers to engage in meaningful student-centred practice, build positive relationships with students, and experience the professional fulfilment that sustains long-term commitment to the profession.

Finally, the study's findings highlight the need for specific policy attention to the National Curriculum sector. The significantly lower satisfaction levels and higher variance in experiences among National Curriculum teachers compared to their English Medium counterparts indicate that conditions in this sector are more precarious and unequal. Given that National Curriculum schools educate the vast majority of Bangladesh's students, improving the working conditions and professional experiences of teachers in this sector is essential not only for teacher wellbeing but also for educational quality and equity.

7.5 Final Reflections

This study began with a simple but important question: do teachers in English Medium and National Curriculum schools in Bangladesh experience their work differently? The answer, confirmed through systematic statistical analysis, is clearly yes. English Medium teachers are more satisfied, work in better-resourced environments, and are less likely to be considering leaving the profession. National Curriculum teachers, despite their central role in providing education to the majority of Bangladeshi children, experience lower satisfaction, greater variability in their working conditions, and stronger pressures toward withdrawal from the profession.

These findings are not merely statistical observations. Behind every mean score and regression coefficient are the professional lives of teachers who enter the classroom every day with a commitment to their students' learning and development. The findings remind us that this commitment is not unconditional — it is sustained or eroded by the conditions under which teachers work, the

recognition they receive, the leadership they experience, and the financial security their work provides. Understanding and improving these conditions is not only a matter of teacher wellbeing. It is a matter of educational quality, equity, and the long-term sustainability of Bangladesh's education system.

References

Addimando, L. (2019). The effect of positive working conditions on work engagement and teaching classroom practices: A large cross-sectional study in Switzerland. *Frontiers in Psychology, 10*, 2129. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2019.02129

Admiraal, W. (2025). Teachers' perspective on their school environment and job satisfaction in Nordic and other European countries. *Scandinavian Journal of Educational Research, 69*(3), 478–492. https://doi.org/10.1080/00313831.2024.2318425

Ahamed, K. F., Billah, M. A. B., & Alam, M. S. (2013). Job satisfaction of public primary school teachers in Bangladesh: A case study in Sherpur District. Journal of Business Studies, 34(1), 229–239.

Akter, R., & Alam, T. (2023). Relation between occupational stress and job satisfaction of primary school teachers: A cross-sectional study in Bangladesh. *International Journal of Scientific Research in Multidisciplinary Studies, 9*(3), 11–18.

Bangladesh Medical Research Council. (2014). *National ethical guidelines for health research in Bangladesh*. BMRC.

Bellibaş, M. Ş., Polatcan, M., Kaya, E., & Frick, W. C. (2025). School leadership types and teacher job satisfaction: A meta-analytic review. Leadership and Policy in Schools. https://doi.org/10.1080/15700763.2025.2543807

Bennell, P., & Akyeampong, K. (2007). *Teacher motivation in Sub-Saharan Africa and South Asia*. DFID.

Björk, L., Stengård, J., Söderberg, M., Andersson, E., & Wastensson, G. (2019). Beginning teachers' work satisfaction, self-efficacy and willingness to stay in the profession: A question of job demands–resources balance? *Teachers and Teaching, 25*(8), 955–971. https://doi.org/10.1080/13540602.2019.1688288

Bray, M., Adamson, B., & Mason, M. (Eds.). (2014). *Comparative education research: Approaches and methods* (2nd ed.). Comparative Education Research Centre, The University of Hong Kong & Springer.

Bryman, A. (2012). *Social research methods* (4th ed.). Oxford University Press.

Cohen, J. (1988). *Statistical power analysis for the behavioral sciences* (2nd ed.). Lawrence Erlbaum Associates.

Creswell, J. W. (2014). *Research design: Qualitative, quantitative, and mixed methods approaches* (4th ed.). SAGE Publications.

Dinham, S., & Scott, C. (1998). A three-domain model of teacher and school executive career satisfaction. *Journal of Educational Administration, 36*(4), 362–378.

Dorji, K., Norbu, J., Norbu, P., & Tshering, S. (2025). Bhutanese teachers' job satisfaction: A cross-sectional study. *Contemporary School Psychology, 29*, 1–20. https://doi.org/10.1007/s40688-023-00482-4

Emerson, R. W. (2015). Convenience sampling, random sampling, and snowball sampling: How does sampling affect the validity of research? *Journal of Visual Impairment & Blindness, 109*(2), 164–168. https://doi.org/10.1177/0145482X1510900215

Eryilmaz, N., Bellibaş, M. Ş., & Berkovich, I. (2025a). Distributed leadership and teacher job satisfaction over time: A large-scale trend analysis of TALIS 2013 and 2018. *Studies in Educational Evaluation, 88*, 101555. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.stueduc.2025.101555

Eryilmaz, N., Kennedy, A. I., Strietholt, R., & Johansson, S. (2025b). Teacher job satisfaction: International evidence on the role of school working conditions and teacher characteristics. *Studies in Educational Evaluation, 86*, 101474. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.stueduc.2025.101474

European Union. (2016). *General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) (Regulation (EU) 2016/679)*. https://eur-lex.europa.eu

Field, A. (2018). *Discovering statistics using IBM SPSS statistics* (5th ed.). SAGE Publications.

Gamero Burón, C., & Lassibille, G. (2016). Job satisfaction among primary school personnel in Madagascar. *The Journal of Development Studies, 52*(11), 1628–1646. https://doi.org/10.1080/00220388.2016.1187726

Herzberg, F., Mausner, B., & Snyderman, B. (1959). *The motivation to work* (2nd ed.). Wiley.

Hussain, S., Saba, N., Ali, Z., Hussain, H., Hussain, A., & Khan, A. (2022). Job satisfaction as a predictor of wellbeing among secondary school teachers. *SAGE Open*, *12*(4), Article 21582440221138726. https://doi.org/10.1177/21582440221138726

Imam, S. R. (2005). English as a global language and the question of nation-building education in Bangladesh. *Comparative Education, 41*(4), 471–486. https://doi.org/10.1080/03050060500317588

Klassen, R. M., & Chiu, M. M. (2010). Effects on teachers' self-efficacy and job satisfaction: Teacher gender, years of experience, and job stress. *Journal of Educational Psychology, 102*(3), 741–756. https://doi.org/10.1037/a0019237

Lester, P. E. (1987). Development and factor analysis of the Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (TJSQ). *Educational and Psychological Measurement*, *47*(1), 223–233.

Lewin, K. M. (2007). *The limits to growth of non-government private schooling in Sub Saharan Africa* (CREATE Research Monograph No. 5). Consortium for Research on Educational Access, Transitions and Equity (CREATE), Centre for International Education, University of Sussex.

Madigan, D. J., & Kim, L. E. (2021). Towards an understanding of teacher attrition: A meta-analysis of burnout, job satisfaction, and teachers' intentions to quit. *Teaching and Teacher Education*, *105*, Article 103425. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tate.2021.103425

Mertler, C. A. (2016). Should I stay or should I go? Understanding teacher motivation, job satisfaction, and perceptions of retention among Arizona teachers. *International Research in Higher Education, 1*(2), 34–45. https://doi.org/10.5430/irhe.v1n2p34

Masoom, M. R. (2021). Teachers' perception of their work environment: Evidence from the primary and secondary schools of Bangladesh. *Education Research International*, *2021*, Article 4787558. https://doi.org/10.1155/2021/4787558

Masum, A. K. M., Azad, M. A. K., & Beh, L.-S. (2015). Determinants of academics' job satisfaction: Empirical evidence from private universities in Bangladesh. *PLoS ONE*, *10*(2), Article e0117834. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0117834

Mousumi, M. A., & Kusakabe, K. (2017). The dynamics of supply and demand chain of English-medium schools in Bangladesh. *Globalisation, Societies and Education*, *15*(5), 679–693. https://doi.org/10.1080/14767724.2016.1223537

Mousumi, M. A., & Kusakabe, T. (2021). School education system in Bangladesh. In P. M. Sarangapani & R. Pappu (Eds.), *Handbook of education systems in South Asia* (pp. 449–472). Springer. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-15-0032-9_11

Noori, A. Q. (2023). Job satisfaction variance among public and private school teachers: A case study. *Cogent Education, 10*(1), 2189425. https://doi.org/10.1080/2331186X.2023.2189425

OECD. (2020). *TALIS 2018 results: Teachers and school leaders as valued professionals*. OECD Publishing.

Pallant, J. (2016). *SPSS survival manual* (6th ed.). McGraw-Hill Education.

Park, J.-H., Cooc, N., & Lee, K.-H. (2020). Relationships between teacher influence in managerial and instruction-related decision-making, job satisfaction, and professional commitment: A multivariate multilevel model. *Educational Management Administration & Leadership*, *51*(1), 116–137. https://doi.org/10.1177/1741143220971287

Pepe, A., Addimando, L., & Veronese, G. (2017). Measuring teacher job satisfaction: Assessing invariance in the Teacher Job Satisfaction Scale (TJSS) across six countries. *Europe's Journal of Psychology, 13*(3), 396–416. https://doi.org/10.5964/ejop.v13i3.1389

Rabbi, M. F. (2026). Teacher challenges: Workload, burnout, and attrition in Khulna, Bangladesh. In I. H. Amzat & M. Khalifa (Eds.), *Handbook of teachers' voices in the Global South* (pp. 139–154). Springer. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-95-2423-5_6

Revilla, M. A., Saris, W. E., & Krosnick, J. A. (2014). Choosing the number of categories in agree-disagree scales. *Sociological Methods & Research, 43*(1), 73–97. https://doi.org/10.1177/0049124113509605

Ryan, R. M., & Deci, E. L. (2000). Intrinsic and extrinsic motivations: Classic definitions and new directions. *Contemporary Educational Psychology, 25*(1), 54–67. https://doi.org/10.1006/ceps.1999.1020

Skaalvik, E. M., & Skaalvik, S. (2011). Teacher job satisfaction and motivation to leave the teaching profession: Relations with school context, feeling of belonging, and emotional exhaustion. *Teaching and Teacher Education, 27*(6), 1029–1038. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tate.2011.04.001

Skaalvik, E. M., & Skaalvik, S. (2017). Motivated for teaching? Associations with school goal structure, teacher self-efficacy, job satisfaction and emotional exhaustion. *Teaching and Teacher Education, 67*, 152–160. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tate.2017.06.006

Small, C., & Buckman, D. (2021). Public and private schools: A study of teacher job satisfaction. *ICPEL Education Leadership Review, 22*(1), 54–71.

Sultana, A., Sarker, M. N. I., & Prodhan, A. Z. M. S. (2017). Job satisfaction of public and private primary school teachers of Bogra District in Bangladesh. *Journal of Sociology and Anthropology, 1*(1), 41–46.

Swedish Research Council. (2017). *Good research practice*. Swedish Research Council.

Tasnim, S. (2006). *Job satisfaction among female teachers: A study on primary schools in Bangladesh* (Unpublished master's thesis). University of Bergen.

Toropova, A., Myrberg, E., & Johansson, S. (2021). Teacher job satisfaction: The importance of school working conditions and teacher characteristics. *Educational Review, 73*(1), 71–97. https://doi.org/10.1080/00131911.2019.1705247

UNESCO. (2015). *Education for all global monitoring report*. UNESCO Publishing.

Wartenberg, G., Aldrup, K., Grund, S., & Klusmann, U. (2023). Satisfied and high performing? A meta-analysis and systematic review of the correlates of teachers' job satisfaction. *Educational Psychology Review, 35*, 114. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10648-023-09831-4

Zebon, M. A. H., Sattar, A., & Ahamed, M. S. (2025). An empirical study of exploring the predictors of university teachers' job satisfaction in Bangladesh: A structural equation modeling approach. *Heliyon*, *11*, e41740. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.heliyon.2025.e41740

Zembylas, M., & Papanastasiou, E. (2004). Job satisfaction among school teachers in Cyprus. *Journal of Educational Administration, 42*(3), 357–374. https://doi.org/10.1108/09578230410534676

Appendix

Appendix A: Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (Adapted TJSQ)

This survey is used to collect data for my master's thesis on teacher job satisfaction in Bangladesh at Stockholm University in Sweden. It is a short version of the Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (TJSQ) adapted from the Teacher Job Satisfaction Questionnaire (TJSQ) developed by Lester (1987). Participation was voluntary and responses were kept anonymous. Participants are free to withdraw from the study at any time by contacting the researchers.

If you have any question, please contact Ismat Ara Tabassum (e-mail-ismataratabassum704@gmail.com) and her supervisor, Professor Shu-Nu Chang Rundgren (e-mail-shu-nu.chang-rundgren@edu.su.se).

Master student

Ismat Ara Tabassum

CONSENT

I have read the information above and voluntarily agree to participate in this study.

☐ Yes, I agree

☐ No, I do not agree (survey will end)

SECTION A: Background Information

Please provide the following information about yourself and your current teaching position.

A1. Which type of school do you currently work in?

☐ English Medium

☐ National Curriculum (Bangla version or English version)

A2. School location

☐ Dhaka

☐ Chattogram

☐ Other city (please specify): _____

A3. School level(s) currently taught

☐ Primary

☐ Secondary

☐ Both primary and secondary

A4. Gender

☐ Male

☐ Female

☐ Prefer not to say

A5. Age group

☐ 20–29 years

☐ 30–39 years

☐ 40 years and above

A6. Highest academic qualification

☐ Bachelor's degree

☐ Master's degree

☐ MPhil / PhD

☐ Other (please specify): _____

A7. Years of teaching experience in your current school

☐ 0–4 years

☐ 5–10 years

☐ More than 10 years

A8. Employment status in your current school

☐ Permanent (full-time)

☐ Permanent (part-time)

☐ Contract / temporary

A9. Monthly salary range (BDT)

☐ Less than 25,000

☐ 25,000–45,000

☐ More than 45,000

☐ Prefer not to say

SECTIONS B–E: Job Satisfaction Factors

Instructions: Please read each statement carefully and indicate the extent to which you agree or disagree with it by selecting the response that best represents your experience. There are no right or wrong answers, we are interested in your honest opinions.

RESPONSE SCALE

1	2	3	4	5
Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree

Section B — Overall Job Satisfaction

JS1. Overall, I am satisfied with my job as a teacher.
JS2. I feel proud to work as a teacher in my school.
JS3. My job meets my expectations as a teacher.
JS4. If I could choose again, I would still choose teaching.

Section C — Key Factors

Leadership / Supervision

L1. My school administration provides clear guidance and constructive feedback.
L2. I feel supported by school leadership when work-related problems arise.

Working Conditions & Resources

R1. My school provides sufficient teaching resources (such as textbooks, teaching aids, and digital materials) to support effective instruction.
R2. Classroom facilities (such as classroom space, furniture, lighting, and ventilation) support effective teaching and learning.

Pay & Benefits

P1. My salary is fair considering my workload and responsibilities.
P2. The benefits provided by my school (e.g., leave, bonuses, allowances) are satisfactory.

Autonomy

A1. I am trusted with meaningful professional responsibilities in my teaching role.
A2. I have sufficient autonomy in choosing teaching methods in my classroom.

Recognition & Respect

REC1. My work is acknowledged and appreciated by school leadership.
REC2. I feel respected as a professional educator in my school.

Collegial Relationships

C1. I have supportive and cooperative relationships with my colleagues.
C2. Teachers in my school regularly cooperate and share ideas.

Workload & Stress

W1. My workload is manageable.
W2. I frequently take work home (e.g., grading or lesson planning). *(R)*
W3. Administrative tasks reduce my time for teaching. *(R)*
W4. I often feel emotionally exhausted after work. *(R)*

System & Societal Factors

S1. Teachers are respected in Bangladeshi society.
S2. Frequent policy or management changes create stress for teachers. *(R)*

Section D — Intention to Stay / Leave

IL1. I plan to continue teaching in my current school next year.
IL2. I often think about leaving my current school. *(R)*
IL3. I often think about leaving the teaching profession. *(R)*
IL4. If I had a better job opportunity, I would leave this school. *(R)*

Section E — Work Itself (Intrinsic Satisfaction)

WI1. My daily teaching activities are engaging and rewarding.
WI2. Teaching gives me a sense of achievement.
WI3. I feel motivated when I see students improve.
WI4. I enjoy working with students.

Thank you for completing this survey!

Your participation is greatly appreciated and will contribute to improving our understanding of teacher job satisfaction in Bangladesh.

Note: [R] indicates reverse-coded items used in data analysis.

Stockholm University
SE-106 91 Stockholm
Phone: 08 – 16 20 00
www.su.se

